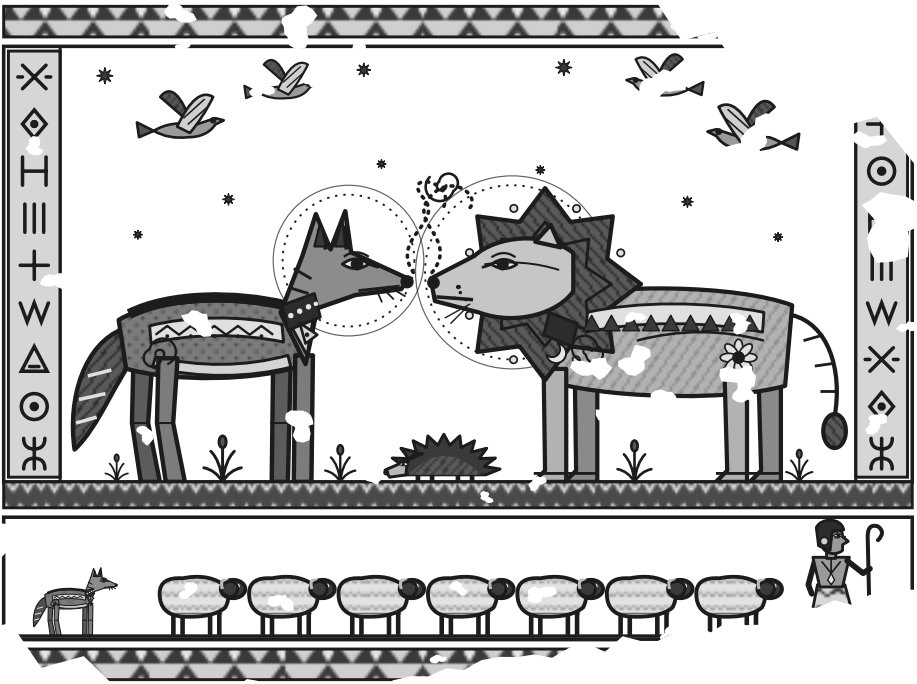
Brahim ZELLAL

Tamacahut n wuccen

The Tale of the Wolf





Tigi d timucuha n wedrar n Ǧeṛǧeṛ, adrar aberkan, adrar n nnif, adrar n lḥif: akken i s-yenna win n zzman:

W'ibɣan lḥeṛma ad tagar
Yali s adrar,
Yečč abelluḍ bu tcacit;
W'ibɣan irden n tfazit
Iṣubb s azaɣar:
Ad yeɣleb agdi d temrit!

Yura-tent ccix Yebṛahim Asedqaw di ttnaṣfa n lqern ṛbeɛṭac, ad yessifes fell-as Ṛebbi di ddunit, yeɛfu fell-as di laxeṛt! Amin!



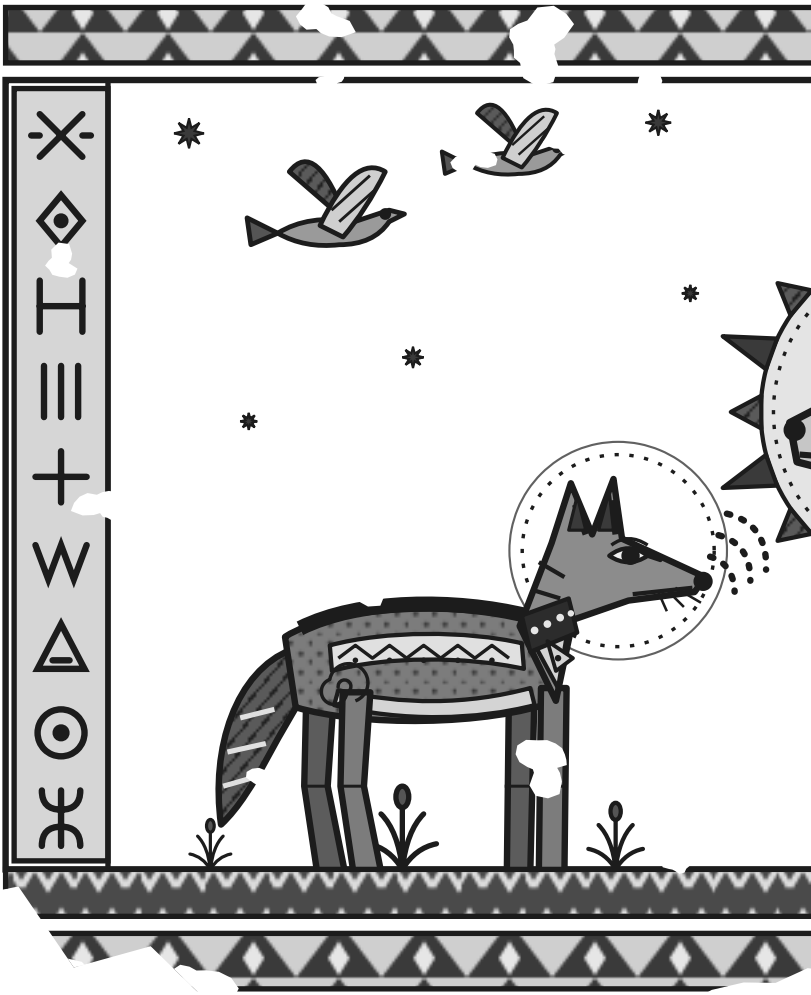
These are the tales of the mountain of Djurdjura, the black mountain, the mountain of honor, the mountain of hardship; as the ancient one used to say:

Whosoever desires that honor should prevail
Let him ascend the mountain,
And feed upon the capped acorn;
Whosoever desires the pure wheat
Let him descend into the plain:
He shall be more abused than a hound!

Written by Sheikh Ibrahim of the Ait Sedqa towards the middle of the fourteenth century, may God lighten his burdens in this world, and grant him forgiveness in the afterlife! Amen!

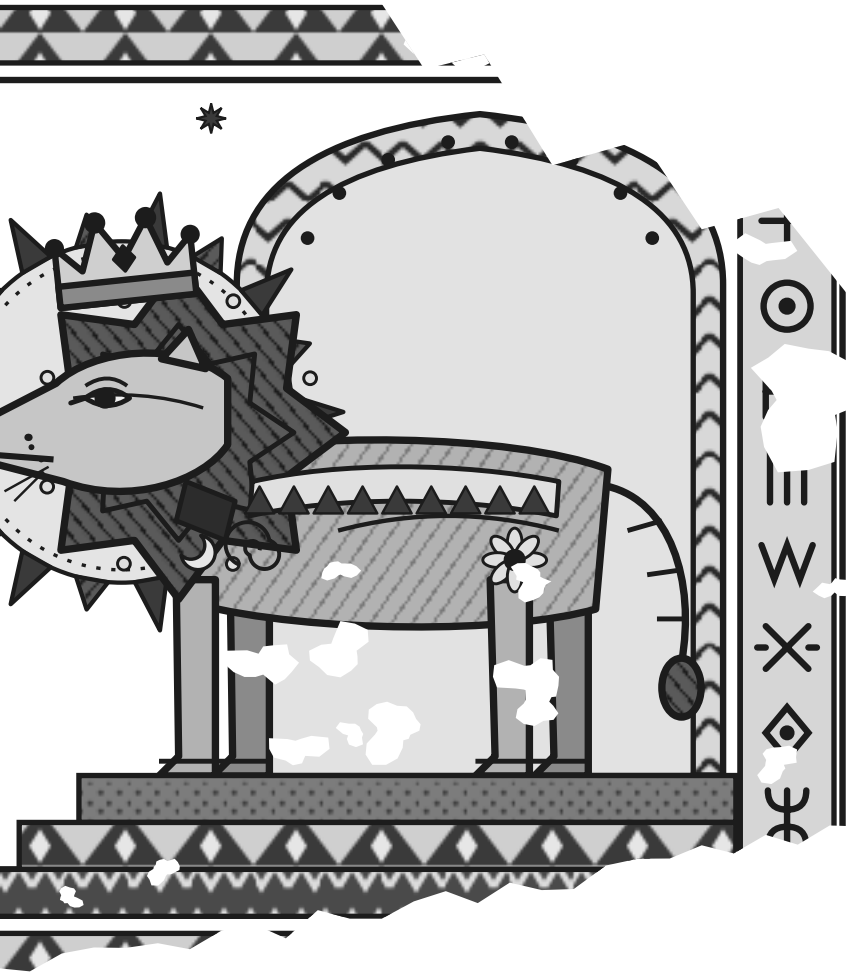
#1

Tamacahut n wuccen d yizem



#1

The Tale of the Wolf and the Lion



Leğmeɛ n lewḥuc

Di zzman amezwaru, nnejmɛen lewḥuc, akken llan, myeɛhaden s Ṛebbi ur myuccčen, ad hennin di ddunit. Semman izem d agellid fell-asen (ay d agellid, ɣas Ṛebbi!), rṣan tilas d inagan.

Izem yezdeɣ di teẓgi d tameqqrant, netta d wuccen d yilef d tewtult d weɣyul d tyaziṭ d tfunast, llan d lxeddam-is, f wakken d-ssawalen tamacahut. Mkul axeddim iqeṭṭu-yas ṣṣalḥa: ilef, yeggan fell-as; uccen, yeddal yiss: tawtult, yessummut-itt; abareɣ yettagem-as-d aman; aɣyul izeddem-as-d isɣaren; tayaziṭ tettarew-as-d timellalin: tafunast tettak-as-d ayefki.

Hennan lewḥuc: teksa taɣaṭ d wuccen! Feṛḥen, aɛlaxaṭer lehna yeḍmen leɣna.

The Assembly of the Animals

In ancient times, the animals gathered together, all of them, and swore by God not to devour one another, so that they could live in peace in the world. They appointed the lion as king over them (though God is the only true King!), and they established borders and covenants.

The lion lived in a vast forest, and the wolf, the boar, the hare, the donkey, the hen, and the cow were his servants, according to how the story is told. To each servant, he assigned a specific task: the boar, he slept upon him; the wolf, he covered himself with him; the hare, he used her as a pillow; the fox fetched water for him; the donkey gathered firewood for him; the hen laid eggs for him; and the cow gave him milk.

The animals lived in peace: the goat grazed alongside the wolf! They rejoiced, because peace guarantees prosperity.

Lḥaṣul, ṣeggmen ddunit lukan ur asen-tt-yessexṣer ara wuccen yerra yizem d amṛayi. Uccen ur yefṛiḥ ara s uṣeggem agi n ddunit: yuɣ tannumi yekkat timeɣriwin; yendem f liḥala taqdimt: mi d-yesmekti aksum azegzaw d idammen yeḥman, ad as-yuɣal d tisselbi. Ass-a ḥeṛmen: acu ara yili w'ixedmen? Ad yeɛṣu? Accaren n yizem qeḍɛen, lḥekm-is akken nniḍen. Ihi, ijebd-d taḥṛaymit, yessefra ad yessefreɣ di lxeddam n yizem s tuffra yiwen yiwen, ad yuɣal d imciṭni.

In short, they arranged the world beautifully, if only the wolf—whom the lion had made his advisor—had not ruined it for them. The wolf did not rejoice in this harmony of the world: he was accustomed to causing chaos; he regretted the old state of affairs. When he remembered fresh meat and warm blood, which were now forbidden, it drove him to madness. What was to be done? Should he disobey? The lion's claws were sharp, and his rule was absolute. Therefore, he resorted to cunning, plotting in secret to incite the lion's servants, one by one, to rebellion, turning into a true demon.

Lmux n ubaṛeɣ

Uccen iḥili yettkel yerna lxeddam irkel kkes abareɣ, mmi-s n ɛemmi-s. Abareɣ yuki d wuccen d lexṛaza-s, yebna f yiman-is. Lameɛna, ayen yebɣa Ṛebbi ad yeḍru: urant.

Yiwwass, yuḍen yizem aṭṭan afessas: yewt-it ubeḥri. Yečča timellalin di ticcent; armi ur d-yefki ara Ṛebbi tawwurt, yesnejmeɛ-d lxeddam irkel, icaweṛ-iten.

Mkul yiwen d aḥeckul d-yerna.
Yenna-yas ubareɣ:
- Ttcekkiṛen idammen n wuccen: qqaren d ddwa ameqqran. Yexẓer yizem Si Mḥemmed… ffɣen ddaw-as.
- Iğaweb-d wuccen: D ṣṣeḥḥ, a lmir n lewḥuc, lameɛna ma xelṭen di lmux n ubareɣ.

Iwwet yizem abareɣ, iɣḍel-d lmux-is yemmut. Yejreḥ wuccen iman-is ljerḥ ameẓyan, yesquddeṛ-d kra idammen, xedmen ddwa i lmir n lewḥuc. Yenna-yas yizem:
- Ddem, a Ben Yeɛqub, ad tneṭleḍ!

The Brain of the Fox

The wolf was confident he was the most cunning among all the servants except for the fox, his cousin. The fox was well aware of the wolf and his trickery, and he stood on his guard. However, what God wills must happen: it was written.

One day, the lion fell ill with a mild ailment: he had caught a cold. He ate eggs with garlic; but since God did not yet grant a recovery, he gathered all the servants together and consulted them.

Everyone suggested a different remedy.
The fox said:

- People praise the blood of the wolf: they say it is a great medicine.

The lion glared at Sir Mḥemmed… and the wolf soiled himself out of fear.

- The wolf replied: It is true, O ruler of the animals, but only if it is mixed with the brain of the fox.

The lion struck the fox, smashing his skull, and he died. The wolf inflicted a small wound upon himself, drawing a few drops of blood, and they prepared the medicine for the ruler of the animals. The lion said to him:

- Take him, O Ben Yeɛqub, and bury him!

Yewwi wuccen abareɣ armi d targa, yečč-it: yenṭel kan taglimt d yeɣsan. Yefṛeḥ, yenna deg wul-is: Tura, ur yelli wugur wala aɛekkeṛ.

The wolf carried the fox away as far as the ditch and devoured him: he buried only the skin and the bones. Rejoicing, he said in his heart: Now, there is no longer any obstacle or hindrance.

Uccen d tewtult

Tusa-d tefsut: tezzegzew tmurt, teğğuğğeg, fsant ttjuṛ, ttarwen lewḥuc.

Iṛuḥ wuccen yewt-as llir i tewtult, yenna-yas:

- Yessetma-m, aha-tent sɛant-d arraw nsent: ad ten-awint i tzirit ad jellben di leḥcic, ad ččen zzeɛteṛ neɣ isegmi ufeqqus. Kem, qqim dagi ad kem yessummut lmir n lewḥuc!

Ur as-d-terri tewtult d aɛṛab wala d aqbayli, lameɛna tegr-d tinexsas: nnḍen-as lehduṛ n wuccen i wul-is, am cečči, qebren-tt.

Ɛeddan kra n wussan, tuɣal tuɣ awal n wuccen: tṛuḥ s izem, tenna-yas s tergigit:

- A lmir n lewḥuc, ad iyi-tserrḥeḍ: bɣiɣ ad ṛuḥeɣ: ɛyiɣ!

Yeɛreḍ yizem ad tt-id-yeṭṭef, ad tt-id-yerr s abrid: iḥawet, yessaged, ur yufi. Teɛṣa-t: abaden! Yewt-itt. yerẓa-tt: yenna-yas:

- Ddem, a Ben Yeɛqub, ad tneṭleḍ!

The Wolf and the Hare

Spring arrived: the earth turned green, the flowers bloomed, the trees budded, and the animals gave birth to their young.

The wolf went and spoke enticingly to the hare, saying to her:

- Look at your sisters, they have already given birth to their little ones: they take them out under the full moon to leap about in the grass, eating thyme or the shoots of melons. As for you, you stay here just to be used as a pillow by the ruler of the animals!

The hare answered him neither in Arabic nor in Kabyle, but she sighed deeply: the words of the wolf wrapped around her heart like a poison, consuming her inside.

A few days passed, and she followed the wolf's words: she went to the lion and said to him, trembling:

- O ruler of the animals, set me free: I want to leave; I am exhausted!

The lion tried to hold her back, to bring her back to her senses: he reasoned with her, he threatened her, but to no avail. She defied him completely! So he struck her, crushing her, and said to him:

- Take her, O Ben Yeɛqub, and bury her!

Yewwi-tt wuccen, yečča-tt, yemceḥ idammen: yefṛeḥ, iğeɛl ussan yelhan qrib ad d-uɣalen.

The wolf carried her away, devoured her, and wiped away the blood: he rejoiced, believing that the good old days were soon about to return.

Uccen d tyaziṭ

Iɛedda wayen iɛeddan, iṛuḥ wuccen ɣer tyaziṭ, yewt-as izli n tyaziḍin, yenna-yas:
- A weltma, d acu kem-yeğğan dagi? Izem, mi d-turweḍ tamellalt, yečč-itt, talli timital-im zedlent; mi ssefṛuṛxent, ffɣen-d yefṛax, ad ten-sḍefṛent tyemmatin tiseɛdiyin s iguduyen d tmizar d tebḥirin, nitni d ibaḥanen irkel d ičuččiwen irkel; mi ɛyan di tikli d wexbaḍ d tyessawt, neɣ yenɣa-ten usemmiḍ, ad ten-jemɛent seddu wafriwen-nsent iwakken ad ḥmun steɛfun; ad imɣurent, ffɣent-d irkel d tifṛax d sut tcebbubin!

Tayaziṭ ur as-t-id-terri imiren merreɣ wala messus, lameɛna tegr-d tinexsas: yesxeṣr-as nneyya. Teqqim kra n wussan, tuɣal awal n wuccen, tṛuḥ s izem, tenna-yas:
- A lmir n lewḥuc, serreḥ-iyi ad ṛuḥeɣ: ɛyiɣ!
Yeɛreḍ yizem ad tt-id-yeṭṭef, ad tt-id-yerr s abrid: iḥawet, yessaged: ur yufi, Tugi: abaden! Yewt-itt, yerẓa-tt. Yenna-yas:
- Ddem, a Ben Yeɛqub, ad tt-tneṭleḍ!

Yewwi-tt wuccen, yečča-tt, yerna yemceḥ idammen. Yefṛeḥ, yenna deg wul-is: Ussan yelhan qerben!

The Wolf and the Hen

Time passed, and the wolf went to the hen, sang her the song of hens, and said to her:
– My sister, what has left you here? The lion, when you lay an egg, eats it, while your peers are brooding; when they hatch, and the little ones come out, the blessed mothers will guide them through the dungheaps, the gardens, and the orchards, all of them are beautiful chicks; when they are tired of walking, scratching, and grazing, or if the cold hurts them, they gather them under their wings so they can warm up and rest; they will grow up, and they will all turn into young pullets with crests!

The hen did not return an answer to him at that moment, neither bitter nor sweet, but she sighed: he had shaken her good faith. She stayed for a few days, then turned back to the wolf's words, went to the lion, and said to him:
– O king of the animals, allow me to leave: I am tired!
The lion tried to catch her, to bring her back to the path: he coaxed, he threatened: he found no way. She refused: never! He struck her and broke her. He said:
– Take her, Ben Yeɛqub, and go bury her!

The wolf took her away, ate her, and wiped the blood. He was joyful and said in his heart: The good days are near!

Uccen d weɣyul

Imiren yebren wuccen s aɣyul, d nnuba-s. Yenna-yas:
- Atma-k, a bu imeẓẓuɣen, ha-ten deg wegdal, di leḥcic ar tɛebbuṭ, ṛwan asennan d umezzir, la ttejɛun, kkaten tuqqra, yiwen ur asen-yettalas. Keč, qqim dagi ad txedmeḍ tacemlit.

Akken yesla weɣyul i imeslayen agi, yebra i imeẓẓuɣen-is, yegr-d tinexsas. Yiwen n yiḍ, s udem n ṣṣbeḥ, yurga yewwi-yas-d Ṛebbi yella deg wegdal netta d weɣyul nniḍen, la ttemyekmazen tuyat, Yefṛeḥ, yendekwal-d seg yiḍes, yufa-d iman-is weḥd-s: tuɣal ddunit deg wul-is d alili.

Iṛuḥ s izem, yenna-yas:
- A lmir n lewḥuc, serreḥ-iyi ad ṛuḥeɣ: ɛyiɣ!
Yeɛreḍ yizem ad t-id-yerr s abrid, ur yufi: aɣyul, ma ifat yeḥṛen, yekfa umeslay. Yewt-it, yerẓa-t, yenna-yas:
- Ddem, a Ben Yeɛqub, ad tneṭleḍ!

Yeskerker-it wuccen armi d iɣẓer, yeqqim-as yečča deg-s geddac n wussan.

The Wolf and the Donkey

Then the wolf turned his attention to the donkey; it was his turn. He said to him:

– Your brothers, O long-eared one, look at them in the meadow, with grass up to their bellies, sated on thistle and lavender, braying and kicking up their heels, and no one has a claim over them. You, you stay here to do the Drudgery.

As soon as the donkey heard these words, he let down his ears and sighed. One night, towards the break of dawn, he dreamed that God had placed him in the meadow, he and another donkey, scratching each other's shoulders. Overjoyed, he woke up with a start from his sleep and found himself all alone: the world turned as bitter as oleander in his heart.

He went to the lion and said to him:
– O king of the animals, allow me to leave: I am tired!
The lion tried to bring him back to the path, but found no way: once a donkey becomes stubborn, talking is over. He struck him and broke him, then said:
– Take him, Ben Yeɛqub, and go bury him!

The wolf dragged him all the way to the ravine, settled down, and fed on him for several days.

Asmi i d-yuɣal, yenna-yas yizem:

- Annaɣ, a Mḥemmed, teğğiḍ-aɣ i fad!

Yuɣ lḥal d uccen i d-yettagmen. Yerra-yas:

- A lmir n lewḥuc, armi d ass-agi ay kfiɣ tanṭelt n wehdum nni: mi neṭleɣ fettus, iḍehṛ-d qejjiṛ; mi neṭleɣ qejjiṛ, iḍehṛ-d fettus!

When he returned, the lion said to him:
– Hey, Mḥemmed, you have left us to die of thirst!
For it was the wolf who used to fetch the water. He replied to him:
– O king of the animals, only today have I finished burying that carcass: whenever I buried a front hoof, a hind leg appeared; and whenever I buried a hind leg, a front hoof appeared!

Uccen d yilef

Seg weɣyul, uccen yeɛna ilef. Yenna-yas:

- Atma-k, ha-ten la ẓẓaden abelluḍ, ttfeggilen akal s temɣilin-nsen ssekfalen abeɛɛuq d iɛemmuṛen. Mi ṛwan, ṛuḥen ṭṭsen deg segnan-nsen, cexxṛen, yiwen ur asen-yettalas. Keč. tuɣaleḍ-as dagi d tagertilt i yizem! Yernu, tḥesbeḍ iman-ik d bab n yiɣil!

The Wolf and the Boar

After the donkey, the wolf turned his attention to the boar. He said to him:

- Your brothers, look at them, they are grinding acorns, digging up the earth with their tusks, and unearthing heaps of starchy tubers. When they are full, they go to sleep in their wallows, snoring, and no one dares to challenge them. But you, you have become like a floor mat for the lion here! And yet, you consider yourself a master of strength!

Ixaq yilef, Yecxeṛ fell-as; yerwel. Iṛuḥ wuccen s izem, yenna-yas:

- A lmir n lewḥuc, qareɛ iman-ik: ufiɣ-n ilef la yesseqḍaɛ timɣilin-is, yettgalla deg-k!

Yenna-yas yizem:

- Amek ara t-ɛeqleɣ ad iyi-d-yebdu?

Yenna-yas wuccen:

- Mi twalaḍ anyir-is yekres, bnu f yiman-ik! (ɣas ar anyir n yilef dayem ikerres!)

Yebren s ilef, yenna-yas:

- Ɛass iman-ik: la yettgalla deg-k yizem!

Yenna-yas yilef:

- Amek ara t-ɛeqleɣ ad iyi-d-yebdu?

Yenna-yas wuccen:

- Mi twalaḍ cclaɣem-is la reqqsen, bnu f yiman-ik! (ɣas ar cclaɣem n yizem dayem reqqsen!)

Wwḍen tameddit, yemmuqel yizem deg yilef, iwala anyir-is yekres; yemmuquel yilef deg yizem, yufa cclaɣem-is la reqqsen. Msemlalen s temɣilin d waccaren, yiwen la iṛeɛɛed, wayeḍ la icexxeṛ.

Uccen ineggez akkin, ar as-yeqqar:

- A tiḥeddiṛt ḥedṛeɣ ass-a!… A dda izem! A dda ilef!…

The boar grew anxious and snorted with anger at him; the wolf fled. The wolf then went to the lion and said to him:

- O king of the animals, protect yourself: I found the boar sharpening his tusks and swearing against you!

The lion said to him:

- How will I recognize that he is about to attack me?

The wolf replied:

- When you see his brow furrowed, prepare yourself! (Even though the brow of a boar is always furrowed!)

He then turned back to the boar and said to him:

- Watch yourself: the lion is swearing against you!

The boar asked him:

- How will I recognize that he is about to attack me?

The wolf replied:

- When you see his whiskers twitching, prepare yourself! (Even though the whiskers of a lion are always twitching!)

When evening arrived, the lion looked at the boar and saw that his brow was furrowed; the boar looked at the lion and found that his whiskers were twitching. They clashed with tusks and claws, one roaring and the other snorting.

The wolf leaped aside, shouting:

- O what a disaster I am witnessing today!… O Uncle Lion! O Uncle Boar!…

Yewt-it yizem, yerẓa-t. Uccen yezla-t, iselx-it, igezm-it d sslayeɛ, ččan seg-s geddac d tiremt. Yefṛeḥ wuccen, yenna deg wul-is: Ussan yelhan uɣalen-d!

The lion struck him and broke his back. The wolf slaughtered him, skinned him, cut him into quarters, and they ate several meals from him. The wolf rejoiced and said in his heart: The good days have returned!

Uccen d tfunast

Teqqim-d tfunast, yeɛreḍ wuccen ad tt-yessinef: ulac lḥila ur as-d-yejbid ara, ulac tamacahut ur as-d-yewwi ara; tugi ad teɛṣu: abaden!
Tenna-yas: Tiẓgi tettɛici-yi: izem yewqem lḥeṛma i teẓgi: sumeḥɣ-as ayefki-w seg wul zeddigen am waman.

Yuɣal wuccen yebren s izem, ar as-yekkat di tfunast: yugi yizem ad as-yessemḥes. Yenna-yas:
- Ḥesbeɣ-tt am yemma: ad fell-as yeɛfu Ṛebbi!
Iɛewweq wuccen, yessusem.

The Wolf and the Cow

The cow remained, and the wolf tried to lead her astray: there was no trick he did not pull on her, and no story he did not bring her; she refused to disobey: never!
She said to him: The forest sustains me: the lion has established respect for the forest: I grant him my milk from a pure heart, like water.

Then the wolf turned to the lion, striking against the cow: the lion refused to listen to him. He said to him:
- I consider her like my mother: may her soul rest in peace!
Perplexed, the wolf fell silent.

Lḥan ayen lḥan, yuɣal-it, yenna-yas:
- A lmir n lewḥuc, d ṣṣeḥ, tafunast ur k-teɛṣi ara, lameɛna ur tezmir ara ad k-tɛic: kečči, mačči, d llufan ad tidireḍ s uyefki; yernu, lmir n lewḥuc, ur as-d-tewwi ara ad yuɣal d ameksa neɣ ad t-ineɣ laẓ. Ma yewweḍ akken ara tellaẓeḍ, qebleɣ ad iyi-teččeḍ nekkini s yiman-iw: tura lewḥuc ɛṣan-k, leɛhed irreẓ, amek ara tɛiceḍ? Yessefk-ak ad tseggdeḍ, neɣ ad k-ineɣ laẓ. Mačči d aksum n tfunast ideg iyi-teḥṣel lmeɛna, d aglim-is: yenna-yi wemɣar azemni, xeddmen seg-s ticifaḍ d lɛali-tent: mi tent-telsiḍ, mačči d tikli ara telḥuḍ neɣ d tazzla ara tazzleḍ: d affug ara tafgeḍ! Ad teṭṭilliḍ i iseddilen d iɣeẓran: ulac lweḥc ur tettaṭṭafeḍ ara deg umecwaṛ: ad ak-tuɣal ṣṣyada d tteqṣir.
Ma d ṛṛay-iw, yessefk tafunast ad temmet aksum-is ad teṭṭfeḍ yess taṛwiḥt, si maḍil ara ifeṛṛeğ Ṛebbi; aglim-is, ad ak-ṣenɛeɣ seg-s ticifaḍ.

Yeqbel yizem, nnig wul: nɣan tafunast, selxen-tt, ččan-tt kra kra, ffren aglim-is.

They went on for some time, then he returned to him and said:

- O king of the animals, it is true, the cow did not disobey you, but she cannot sustain you: you yourself are not a baby to live on milk; furthermore, for the king of the animals, it is unbefitting for the king of animals to become a herder merely to avoid perishing from hunger. If it comes to the point where you starve, I accept that you eat me, my very self: now the animals have disobeyed you, the pact is broken, how will you live? You must hunt, or hunger will kill you. It is not the meat of the cow that catches my attention, it is her hide: a wise old man told me that they make excellent shoes from it: when you wear them, it is not walking that you will walk or running that you will run: it is flying that you will fly! You will look down upon the thickets and the ravins: there is no beast you will not catch in a short distance: hunting will become a pastime for you.

If it is my advice, the cow must die so you can sustain your soul with her meat, until God brings relief; as for her hide, I will craft the shoes for you out of it.

The lion accepted, against his heart: they killed the cow, skinned her, ate her bit by bit, and hid her hide.

Ticifaḍ n wuccen

Yewweḍ-d unebdu, yuẓa-d uɣamac. Imelleḥ wuccen aglim n tfunast, idhen-it, ifser-it i tili iwakken ad yeqqar s lɛql-is.

Asmi yewǧed, igzem-it d isriḥen d tyigiwin, yextaṛ seg-sent snat n lɛali i yizem. iqass-as-tent, armi d-ṣebḥent, yebda lexṛaza: mi d-yewwi seg weglim n tfunast, yernu-d seg weglim n yizem, ixiḍ tindict: mkul nnefda, ad isuɣ yizem, ad as-yini wuccen:

- Akken qerrḥent ay neffɛent!

Ixerreẓ di tcifaḍ agi si ṣṣbeḥ armi d azal: yiwen yettsuɣu, wayeḍ yeqqar-as:

- Akken qerrḥent ay neffɛent!

Imiren yewwi-t armi d yiwet n tiɣilt nnig yefri d ameqran, yerra-t tinnegnit, yenna-yas:

- Mekken iḍarren-ik i ṛebɛa i yiṭij: alamma qqurent tcifaḍ ara lhunt.

The Shoes Crafted by the Wolf

Summer had arrived; the heat became oppressive. The wolf salted the cow's hide, oiled it, and spread it out in the shade so that it would dry slowly.

When it was ready, he cut it into strips and sections; he chose two of the best pieces for the lion. He fitted them to him, and once they were properly sized, he began his cobbling: for every stitch, he passed the needle through the hide of the cow and then through the skin of the lion. Each time the needle pierced, the lion would roar, and the wolf would tell him:

- The more they hurt, the more good they do!

He cobbled away at these shoes from morning until noon: one was roaring, and the other was saying:

- The more they hurt, the more good they do!

Then he led him to a knoll just above a great cave, made him lie on his back, and said to him:

- Direct your four feet toward the sun: the shoes will not be ready until they are dry.

Yeqqim din yizem i yiṭij n ssmayem armi d tizwa: ssewwen iḍarren-is: yeqqur fell-asen weglim. Tekka fell-as tkeffaṛt. Uccen iqubel-it-id i tili si lbeɛd. Mi d-yebda ubeḥri, yessawel-as, yenna-yas:
- Neggez tura: ad teẓreḍ ma ur tettafgeḍ ara am wefṛux deg genni!

Ineggez yizem di lkaf, yegrareb f qerru f iḍarren armi d lqaɛa n yeɣẓer: yeqtel irkel: ula d addud ur yezmir ara ad ibedd. Uccen yendi-yas-tt ad t-ineɣ, ad t-yečč ula d netta, armi i t-iwala yemneɛ, yerwel.

S udem n tmeddit, a-t-a lferg usekkur yuɣ-d iɣẓer d tasawent, yufa-d izem di yir lḥala.
Nnant-as tsekkrin:
- Ɛahed-aɣ s Ṛebbi ur aɣ-teččiḍ, ad k-nsellek!

Iɛahed-itent. Uɣalent ar d-ttawint aman deg qubab-nsent, slexsent ticifaḍ armi yerḍeb weglim; xesfent-d lexyuḍ, ɣlint tcifaḍ, Yemmeɣ yizem s leḥṛaṛa f tsekkurt, yesseblɛɛ-itt: yerẓa leɛhud n Ṛebbi. Yuɣal ifa: tufeg-d tedder seg uɛebbuḍ-is!

The lion remained there under the midsummer sun until the afternoon breeze: his feet were burning hot, and the hide dried and tightened upon them. He suffered agonizing pain. The wolf faced him from afar, watching from the shade. When the breeze picked up, he called out to him and said:

- Jump now! You will see if you do not fly like a bird in the sky!

The lion jumped into the cliff and tumbled head over heels down to the bottom of the ravine: he was completely broken, and he could not even stand up. The wolf had set this trap for him to kill him so that he could eat him too, but when he saw that he survived, he fled.

Toward evening, a covey of partridges moved up the ravine and found the lion in a terrible state.
The partridges said to him:

- Swear to us by God that you will not eat us, and we will save you!

He made the pact with them. They began bringing water in their beaks, soaking the shoes until the leather softened; they cut away the threads, and the shoes fell off. Filled with fierce hunger, the lion pounced upon a partridge and swallowed her whole: he broke his oath to God. Then he gaped, and she flew out alive from his stomach!

Yekker yizem la ileḥḥu inedder armi d lɣar-is, yeṭṭes: ur as-yexdim ara waṭṭan annect i s-yexdem wurrif.

The lion got up and went groaning back to his cave, where he lay down: he did not suffer from his injuries as much as he suffered from his rage.

Ttaṛ n yizem

Yeḥbes yizem geddac n wussan di lɣar-is; uɣalen iḍarren-is ibezgen ṭṭreḍqen d arṣeḍ, teğğa-t tawla i t-yettaɣen seg-sen.

Mi d-yesmekti taḍsa yeḍsa fell-as wuccen, d lexdiɛa i t-yexdeɛ, ad iṛɛed am tegnewt.

Asmi ccwi, yekker yeffeɣ ad iqelleb f wuccen, ad d-yerr ttaṛ-is. Yetti-d fell-as ddunit d wi tt-yuman, ur t-yufi.
Yiwwass, yessemlal-iten Ṛebbi deg wemḍiq: ssya u ssya, d lḥiḍ n weẓru iṣeggem am trigla. Uccen, tekfa fell-as ddunit: iwala lmut teḥdeṛ-d: tusa-d mm lḥeq!

Yewt-it yizem am falku, izgel-it: igzem-as kan ajeḥniḍ! Uccen cṭir, terna-yas tugdi lxaffa: yuli deg weẓru am wemcic di lḥiḍ. Yewweḍ ɣer lemneɛ, nnig wemḍiq, yeqqim din: qquren ifadden-is, la yettergigi am yifer.

The Vengeance of the Lion

The lion stayed inside his cave for many days; his feet became swollen and burst with suppuration, and the fever that caught him from them left him helpless.

When he remembered the laugh the wolf had laughed at him, and the betrayal he had betrayed him with, he would thunder like a storm cloud.

When he felt slightly better, he rose and went out to search for the wolf, to take his revenge. He turned the world upside down and looked everywhere, but he did not find him. One day, God brought them together in a place: from this side and that side, it was a wall of rock straight as a snare. For the wolf, the world came to an end: he saw death present before him: the owner of justice had arrived!

The lion struck at him like a falcon and missed him: he only cut off his tail! The wolf was clever, and fear added to his swiftness: he climbed up the rock like a cat on a wall. He reached safety, out of reach, and sat there: his limbs stiffened, and he was shaking like a leaf.

Yesxenzer yizem ajeḥniḍ n wuccen s wuglan-is d waccaren-is armi ineẓ-d ur yeddi d gma-s, yuɣal yenna-yas:

- A Mḥemmed, ay axeddeɛ, cfu f imeslayen-iw, tgeḍ leqrar i yiman-ik! Tikelt agi zegleɣ-k, temneɛḍ-iyi, lameɛna ɛllmeɣ-k: anda telliḍ ad k-ɛeqleɣ ger watma-k: ɣas ad teqqim ddunit yiwwass, ad k-ṭṭfeɣ, ad k-rẓeɣ deg uzagur, ur tettnejbaṛeḍ ara: ad ččeɣ lmux-ik, sweɣ idammen-ik!

Ssyen, mkul yiwen yuɣ abrid-is.

The lion tore the wolf's tail with his teeth and his claws until it was shredded completely, then he turned and said to him:

– Oh Mḥemmed, you betrayer, remember my words, you have sealed your own fate! This time I missed you and you escaped me, but I warn you: wherever you are, I will recognize you among your brothers. Even if the world has only one day left, I will catch you, I will break your backbone so you will never be mended: I will eat your brains and drink your blood!

From then on, each one took his own path.

Tameɣrust n "ḥdeṛ bbwa"

Seg wasmi i s-yettwagzem ujeḥniḍ, ur ihenna wuccen: ikcem-it ttexmim d uḥebbeṛ. Seg wakken iɛewweq amek ara yexdem, iṛuḥ s amɣer azemni ad t-id-iciweṛ. Yefka-yas-d asɣar n tmeɣrust yeqqur, yerna iḍebber fell-as.

Yewwi-t wuccen, yeẓẓa-t di tniri. Deg yiwet n teswiɛt, yezzegzew, fetḥen lɛiwen-is, fkan-d iferrawen, ṣeggmen ifurkawen, yuɣal d taneqlett. Ssyen, tefruri tazart, wwant tbexsisin, la d-ɣellin iniɣman ileqqaqen ur yelli d lweqt-nsen.

Imiren yendeh wuccen f watmaten-is, usan-d irkel, tɛeğğben: tameɣrust n Belɛejjuḍ tewwa! Bdan la tetten tazart taleqqaqt, ttnaɣen. Yenna-yasen Mḥemmed:
- Ay atmaten, annect agi d leqbiḥ, yecmet!

Yuɣal, iwakken ad d-ters leqniɛa deg wulawen-nsen, yernu mkul yiwen ad yečč leḥq-is, icadd-asen irkel tiɣaṭṭwin s wemrar ɣer lğedra n tmeɣrust, imiren ihuzz-itt, tuɣal tazart am wakal di lqaɛa.

Uccanen la tetten, mkul yiwen iqeddem tirni-s, netta yeqqim-asen-d d aɛessas f yiwet n tiɣilt tqureb-iten-id.

The Fig Tree of "Watch out for it!"

From the day his tail was cut off, the wolf was never at peace: worry and anxiety entered him. Because he was so confused about what to do, he went to an ancient elder to consult him. The elder gave him a dry cutting of a fig tree and advised him on what to do.

The wolf took it and planted it in a desert plain. In an instant, it turned green, its buds opened, it put forth leaves, its branches formed, and it became a fig tree. Then, the figs hatched, the early figs ripened, and the soft, sweet fruits began to fall before their season.

Right away, the wolf called out to his brothers; they all came and were amazed: the marvelous fig tree was ripe! They began to eat the soft figs and fight each other. Mḥemmed said to them:
– Oh brothers, this behavior is wicked and ugly!

Then, so that contentment would settle in their hearts and each one would eat his fair share, he tied all of their tails with a rope to the trunk of the fig tree. Then, he shook it, and the figs became like dust on the ground.

The wolves ate, each advancing in his own row, while he stood watch over them from a nearby hill.

Akken iwala lhan d cceɣl-nsen, stamnen, yebda ar yekkat yettsuɣu:
- Uccayen! Imnayen! A Ben Yeɛqub, a-ten-ayen! Mxeṛwaɛen wuccanen, jebden rewlen, mkul yiwen d abrid i t-yefkan, ğğan irkel tiɣaṭṭwin-nsen deg wemrar.

Yefṛeḥ Mḥemmed: ayen yebɣa yewweḍ ɣur-s: tura uccanen irkel ur sɛin ara ijeḥnaḍ: ulamek i t-yeɛqel yizem gar-asen!

As soon as he saw they were fully occupied and felt safe, he began to strike and shout:
– The hounds! The horsemen! Oh Ben Yeɛqub, there they are!
The wolves panicked, pulled with all their might, and fled, each taking whichever path opened before them, leaving all of their tails behind in the rope.

Mḥemmed rejoiced: he had achieved what he wanted. Now, all of the wolves had no tails: there was no way for the lion to recognize him among them!

Tibḥrt n lebṣel

Yiwwass, yeffeɣ yizem ad iṣegged, yemmuger yiwen n wuccen yettwagzem-as ujeḥniḍ. Yewt-it, yerẓa-t, yečča lmux-is, yessegra idammen-is: iɣil yenɣa aɛdaw-is. Azekka nni, yemlal-d d wuccen nniḍen yettwagzem-as ula d netta ujeḥniḍ.

Yewhem wayrad: yeṭṭef-it, yesteqsa-t, yeḥka-yas-d tamsalt n tmeɣrust n "ḥdeṛ bbawa"; isserreḥ-as, iṛuḥ.

Seg wakken iɛewweq yizem amek ara yexdem, iṛuḥ s amɣar azemni ad t-id-iciwer, ad iḍebber fell-as. Yenna-yas:
- Ṛuḥ, xdem tibḥirt n lebṣel aqerḥan, tawiḍ ɣur-s uccanen irkel ad t-ɣeẓẓen: a win d-yennan: ḥ ḥ ḥ! d win ay d axṣim-ik!

Iṛuḥ yizem yekrez taɣzut kamel s waccaren-is, yeẓẓa-tt d lebṣel, iketteṛ deg-s urḍan. Ur teqqim ara tebḥirt tezzegzew am lebḥeṛ. Imiren, yendeh f wuccanen, usan-d irkel. Ye deg-sen ad t-ɣeẓẓen, ur d-yettɣimi yifer wala tabellust. Yenna-yasen:
Win ara d-yinin: ḥ ḥ ḥ! ad t-ččeɣ, ṣṣeḥḥa u ṣṣlaḥ, lqewwa u ccbeḥ!

The Onion Garden

One day, the lion went out to hunt and met a wolf whose tail was cut off. He struck him, broke him, ate his brains, and licked up his blood; he believed he had killed his enemy. The next day, he met another wolf who also had his tail cut off.

The lion was amazed: he caught him and questioned him, and the wolf told him the story of the "Watch out for it!" fig tree; he let him go, and the wolf left.

Because the lion was so confused about what to do, he went to the ancient elder to consult him and ask for his advice. The elder said to him:
– Go, make a garden of very sharp onions, and bring all the wolves there to chew them up. Whoever says: ḥ ḥ ḥ!, that one is your enemy!

The lion went and plowed a whole fertile valley entirely with his claws, planted it with onions, and watered it heavily. Before long, the garden turned green like the sea. Then, he called out to the wolves, and they all came. He coerced them to chew them all up, so that not a single leaf or bulb would remain. He said to them:
– Whoever says: ḥ ḥ ḥ!, I will eat him, health and heartiness, strength and handsomeness!

Bdan wuccanen la ɛeddren; yiwen ur d-yenni: ḥ ḥ ḥ!…
Ḥaca axṣim n yizem, lameɛna yetḥeṛma: iwakken ad yekkes zzeɛf, mi iɣeẓẓa cwiṭ, yin'as:
- Niɣ, a sidi, tenniḍ win ara d-yinin: ḥ ḥ ḥ! ad t-ččeɣ, ṣṣeḥḥḥa u ṣṣlaḥḥḥ, lqewwa u ccbeḥḥḥ!
Yin'as yizem:
- Swa-swa!
Ad yernu cwiṭ ad yenṭeq s uccanen:
- Teslam, ay atmaten? Iɛeggen-awen lmir n lewḥuc ɣur-wat ad tettum: win ara d-yinin: ḥ ḥ ḥ! ad t-yečč, ṣṣeḥḥḥa u ṣṣlaḥḥḥ, lqewwa u ccbeḥḥḥ!
Ad as-inin:
- Swa-swa!

Akkenni, armi yekfa lebṣel, ur d-teqqim tbellust wala ifer, izem ur yefhim ara, axṣim ur d-iban ara.

The wolves began to crunch; not one of them said: ḥ ḥ ḥ!... except the lion's enemy. However, he was clever: to relieve his burning mouth, whenever he chewed a little, he would say to him:

— Is it not so, my lord, that you said whoever says: ḥ ḥ ḥ! you will eat him, ḥ-ḥ-ḥ-health and ḥ-ḥ-ḥ-heartiness, strength and ḥ-ḥ-ḥ-handsomeness!

The lion replied to him:

— Exactly!

Then he would turn to the other wolves and speak after chewing a bit more:

— Did you hear, my brothers? The king of the animals has warned you, watch out lest you forget: whoever says: ḥ ḥ ḥ!, he will eat him, ḥ-ḥ-ḥ-health and ḥ-ḥ-ḥ-heartiness, strength and ḥ-ḥ-ḥ-handsomeness!

They would answer him:

— Exactly!

In this way, until the onions were completely gone and not a bulb or a leaf remained, the lion did not understand the trick, and his enemy was never found out.

Lmut n wuccanen

Iwala yizem ad as-yemneɛ Mḥemmed, ur d-yetterra ara seg-s ttaṛ.

Yuɣal yendi-yasen i wuccanen ad mmten irkel, ad yettekki wexṣim-is.

Iṣubb-iten s asif. Uccanen, yeččuṛ uɛebbuḍ-nsen d lebṣel aqerḥan: tekker tmes di tyersi d iẓerman-nsen. Ye deg-sen ad swen asif kamel, ad t-ḥebsen, mačči ad tɛeddi tiqit.

Bdan la tessen armi ɛellelen, ṭṭemblen iɛebbaḍ-nsen seg waman d lebṣel, la snukkufen: Ḥebsen ur zmiren ad rnun wala ad rewlen. Mḥemmed ifhem-itt: isers kan imi-s f waman, ur yenṭerr ara.

Ssyen, inheṛ-iten wayrad armi d ifri nni deg yegrareb. Ye deg-sen ad neggzen: d lmut qbala, lameɛna, izem, d ayen ugaden i-yebɣa: iḥreṣ-iten: bdan ar ttneggizen. Mi ineggez yiwen, seg-sen, yegrireb deg yefri, teṭṭerḍeq tɛebbuṭ-is, yemmet, ineggez wayeḍ, yegrireb, yemmet am umezwaru armi i d-yeqqim Mḥemmed d aneggaru. Ijelleb deg yefri, yerwel, yemneɛ: armi d imiren i t-yeɛqel yizem.

The Death of the Wolves

The lion saw that Mḥemmed would escape him, and that he would not take his revenge upon him.

He turned to trap all the wolves so they would all die, so that his enemy would be included among them.

He brought them down to the river. The wolves, their bellies were full of sharp, pungent onions: fire had ignited in their throats and their intestines. He coerced them to drink the entire river, to stop its flow, so that not a single drop would pass.

They began to drink until they choked, their bellies bloated from the water and the onions, and they gasped for breath: they stopped, unable to add another drop or to flee. Mḥemmed understood it: he simply placed his mouth on the water and suffered no harm.

After that, the lion drove them like cattle to that precipice down which he had rolled. He coerced them to jump: it was certain death, but what they feared was exactly what the lion desired: he pressed them, and they began to jump. When one of them leaped, he rolled down the precipice, his belly burst, and he died; another jumped, rolled down, and died just like the first one, until Mḥemmed was left as the last. He bounded into the precipice, fled, and escaped: only then did the lion recognize him.

Yebren lmir n lewḥuc ɣer lɣar-is, ur t-yewwi igenni, ur t-tewwi tmurt: la iṛeɛɛed si zzeɛf, terna-yas nndama imi yenɣa uccanen irkel baṭel.

The king of animals turned back to his cave, neither the sky nor the earth could hold him: he was thundering with rage, compounded by the regret of having killed all the wolves in vain.

Aṭṭan n yizem

Yesteɛmel yizem men yuɣ yuɣ dayen, ur as-teḥṣil ara lmeɛna deg wuccen. Ur iqelleb fell-as, ur yesteqsa deg-s geddac. Yebɣa ad t-iwet di laman.

Asmi iğeɛl yettu lḥal, isers-d f yiman-is aṭṭan ameqran, la yettergigi, inedder.

Iceggeɛ ɣer lewḥuc ad d-asen, ad mmeẓren, ad msamaḥen. Umnen lewḥuc: usan-d. A win ikecmen ɣer lɣar-is, ad t-id-iẓer, yečč-it; a win ikecmen ɣer lɣar-is, ad t-id-iẓer, yečč-it! Ula d yiwen ur d-yeffiɣ d ssalem!

Yusa-d ula d uccen. Yessawel-as si beṛṛa, yenna-yas:
- A lmir n lewḥuc, amek telliḍ?

Iɛeql-it-id yizem, yeldi-d allen-is, yufa-t yebɛed, Yuɣal ar d-yettru amzun tewweḍ-it-id mm lḥeq:
- Kecm-d, a Mḥemmed, ad nemsamaḥ! Nek, a-tt-a teṛwiḥt di lfawatt!

The Illness of the Lion

For a certain time, the lion acted as though the matter were entirely finished, and he no longer paid any mind to the wolf. He did not look for him, nor did he ask about him at all. He wanted to strike him when he felt safe.

When he judged that enough time had passed for it to be forgotten, he brought a great illness upon himself, trembling and groaning.

He sent word to the animals to come, so they could see one another and forgive each other. The animals believed it: they came. Whoever entered his cave to see him, he ate them; whoever entered his cave to see him, he ate them! Not even a single one came out safe and sound!

The wolf came as well. He called out to him from outside, saying to him:
– O king of animals, how are you?

The lion recognized him, opened his eyes, and found him far away. He turned back to weeping as if the bringer of justice had reached him:
– Come in, Mḥemmed, so we may forgive each other! As for me, my soul is departing!

Yugi wuccen, yerra-yas:

- Ad nemsamaḥ kan ssya. Ḥareɣ: ɣur-i ccɣel!

Armi i t-id-yeḥṛes yizem, yenna-yas:

- Ala lğeṛṛa uṣubbu ay ufiɣ, tin n tuɣalin, ulac!

Iṛɛed yizem am tegnewt, yenna-yas:

- Ad k-ineɛl Ṛebbi, ay axeddeɛ! A cciṭan yerẓan leɛhud n Ṛebbi! Ad ig Ṛebbi ddnub n widen irkel deg tsewwqeḍ armi ten-nɣiɣ ad ak-ɛellqen i yiri weḥd-k ass n lḥisab d lɛiqab! Seg wass-a d tasawent, nek yid-k, taɛdawt terṣa; seg wass-a d tasawent, ger dderya-w d dderya-k, taɛdawt terṣa alamma tenger ddunit!

Ssyen, mkul yiwen yuɣ abrid-is.

Mazal ar ass-a, taɛdawt terṣa ger yezmawen d wuccanen.

Mi k-tuɣ deg yiḍ di lexla, uccanen la neṭṭqen neɣ sekkren timeḥbibert, fhem belli bu tissas ulaḥed-it di tmurt nni; ma temsusam ddunit, ur la neṭṭqen ara wuccanen, neɣ la yekkat walbeɛḍ seg-sen agemmaḍ, fhem belli lmir n lewḥuc, bab n tmurt, yella di twanaṭ nni.

The wolf refused, replying to him:
– Let us forgive each other only from right here. I am in a hurry: I have work to do!

When the lion pressed him further, he said to him:
– I find only the tracks of going down; as for tracks of returning, there are none!

The lion thundered like a storm cloud, saying to him:
– May God curse you, you traitor! O devil who broke the covenants of God! May God place the sins of everyone you manipulated, until I ended up killing them, onto your neck alone on the day of reckoning and punishment! From this day forward, between me and you, enmity is established; from this day forward, between my children and your children, enmity is established until the world is destroyed!

After that, each one went his own way.

Even to this day, enmity remains established between lions and wolves.

When it catches you at night in the wilderness, and the wolves are calling out or raising a racket together, understand that the master of courage is nowhere in that land; if the world falls silent and the wolves do not call out, or if just one of them barks from the opposite ridge, understand that the king of animals, the master of the land, is present in that vicinity.

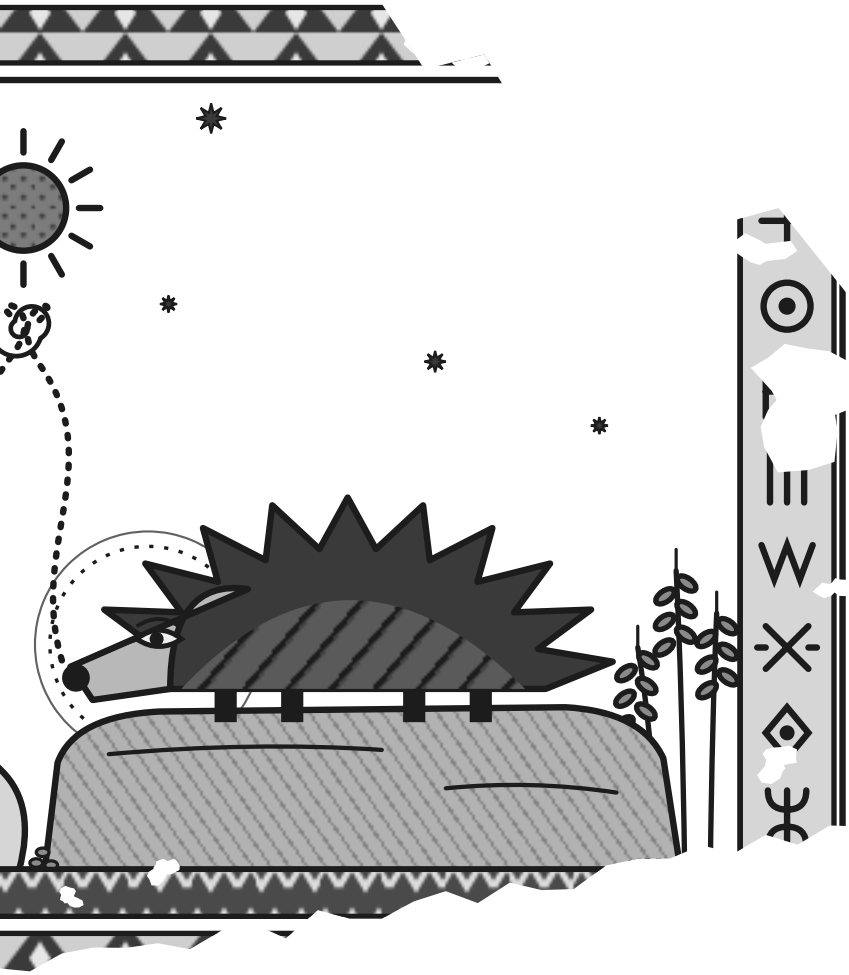
#2

Tamacahut n wuccen d inisi



#2

The Tale of the Wolf and the Hedgehog



Di tebḥirt

Iṛuḥ wuccen, bu meyya tḥila, yecrek taxxamt d inisi, bu yiwet n tḥilett yettsellik yess iman-is, d nnefṣ ireṭṭel-it i yemdukal-is.

Assenni, ṛuḥen ad d-akren tibḥirt ssarmen, deg-s ayen d-yettkatab Ṛebbi. Bab-is yerẓa-tt, yules-itt, izebbel-itt, yeẓẓa-tt, iḥemmeṛ-itt, yessew-itt; yenneḍ-as ẓẓerb ur as-yeṭṭilli ara wuccen.

Ufan tawwurt ger tgusa, kecemen. Ččan s tawant taxsayt, afeqqus, llubyan, ṭumaṭic sxelḍen s ifelfel d lebṣel d ticcert d leḥbeq.

Inisi yellan d akeyyas, mi yečča cwiṭ iṛuḥ iqiss iman-is di tewwurt; uccen yečča armi yeṭṭembel. Slan i lhaffa n bab n tebḥirt iṛuḥ-d ad yessefqed: rewlen: inisi iɛedda-d di tewwurt: uccen ur yezmir ara: yeffeɣ-it leɛqel. Yenna-yas inisi:

- Err iman-ik temmuteḍ!

Yekcem bab n tebḥirt, yaf-n uccen yeẓẓel, yebzeg am uyeddid, iḥseb-it yemmut. Yessusef, iɛewwed, yeṭṭef-it seg uḍar, iḍegger-it ɣer beṛṛa n tebḥirt: yerwel.

In the Garden

The wolf, master of a hundred ruses, went to share a den with the hedgehog, master of a single ruse by which he saves himself, plus a half-ruse that he lends to his friends.

That day, they went to rob a garden they had hoped for, containing whatever God had provided in it. Its owner had broken its soil, tilled it again, fertilized it, planted it, hilled it, and watered it; he had surrounded it with a hedge so tight that a wolf could not even look through it.

They found an opening between the stakes and entered. They ate to satiety squash, melon, and beans, mixing tomatoes with chili pepper, onion, garlic, and basil.

The hedgehog, who was clever, after eating a little bit, went to measure himself against the opening; the wolf ate until he was bloated. They heard the footsteps of the owner of the garden coming to inspect it: they fled: the hedgehog passed through the opening: the wolf could not: he lost his mind. The hedgehog said to him:
— Pretend you are dead!

The owner of the garden entered, found the wolf stretched out, swollen like a waterskin, and thought he was dead. He spat, uttered a protective blessing, grabbed him by the leg, and threw him outside the garden: he fled.

Yeqqim wergaz la yeskifif.

The man remained behind, throwing insults after him.

Di tesraft n nneɛma

Tusa-d teggara n lxṛif, wten waman, teṛwa tmurt, yewwa wakal. Yiwwass, iṛuḥ inisi d wuccen ad d-akren yiwet n tesraft n nneɛma.

Yekkes-as ufellaḥ aɣummu, armi i tt-yufa teswa, iɛemmeṛ-d irden uṛciḥen, yeğğa-tt ad tekkaw. Jellben ɣer daxel, qqimen la tetten. Inisi ur yettu ara iman-is: yečča ayen i s-yekteb Ṛebbi, yuɣal yenna-yas wuccen:

- Eg-iyi taɛrurt ad muqleɣ wi ɣ-d-yettafen!

Ibedd wuccen, yuli inisi f zagur-is d temgerṭ-is, ineggez ɣer beṛṛa, yerwel.

Uccen, armi d imiren i yas-tent-iwwet waḍu: iɛecca yettneggiz iwakken ad yeffeɣ, ur yufi.

Yesla i ufellaḥ la d-ileḥḥu: yemsex iman-is lxuf. Yuɣal yeẓẓel, yerra iman-is yemmut: akken yexdem di tebḥirt.

Yewweḍ-d ufellaḥ, iwala-t yebzeg am uyeddid, imi-s d imeẓẓuɣen-is ččuṛen d irden; tasraft, iɛefn-itt irkel: iğeɛl-it yemmut, iwwet deg fassen-is, isuɣ:

- A zzehṛ-iw!

In the Grain Silo

The end of autumn arrived, the waters fell, the earth was drenched, and the soil became ripe. One day, the hedgehog and the wolf went to steal from a grain silo.

The peasant had removed the cover, and once he found it had taken in water, he gathered the wet wheat and left the silo to dry. They jumped inside and sat eating. The hedgehog did not forget himself: he ate what God had written for him, and then he said to the wolf:
– Give me your back so I can look out for whoever might find us!

The wolf stood up, the hedgehog climbed onto his back and his neck, leaped outside, and fled.

Only then did the wind hit the wolf: He persistently tried to jump and escape, but to no avail.

He heard the peasant approaching: he soiled himself in fear. Then he stretched out and made himself appear dead, just as he had done in the vegetable garden.

The peasant arrived and saw him bloated like a waterskin, his mouth and ears stuffed with wheat, and the silo completely soiled; believing him to be dead, he clapped his hands and cried out:
– Oh, my luck!

Yuɣal yers ɣer daxel n tesraft, iɛewwed, yessusef, yeṭṭef uccen s uceṭṭiḍ, iḍegger-it-id ɣer beṛṛa: yerwel!

Yeqqim wergaz, ṭṭef deg wudem-is, tamseḍ!

Then he stepped down into the silo, uttered a protective blessing, spat, grabbed the wolf with a rag, and flung him outside: he fled!
The man remained there, holding his face in utter dismay!

Tamsalt n leɛmeṛ

Tusa-d ccetwa, ageffur, aḍu abruri adfel.
Yiwwass, yeddukel wuccen d inisi. Lluẓen, la ttqelliben acu ara ččen. Yekfa lexṛif nni degmi n-yufa wuccen tazart am wakal di lqaɛa, yenna-yas: jmeɛ lxiṛ-im, a tameɣrust!
Tura, mi iɛedda ddaw-as, yin'as: ɛmu-yi-d! Mi iwala tarbibt n waḍil di tecwawt n ttejṛa, yin'as: semmum! semmum!

Ufan iniɣem deg webrid yeɣli-yas i walbeɛḍ imeksawen. Yenna-yas inisi:
- Ad t-nebḍu.
- Yenna-yas wuccen: Ala! A win meqqren deg-neɣ di leɛmeṛ ad t-yečč!
- Yenna-yas inisi: Melmi tluleḍ?
- Yenna-yas wuccen: Asmi yerɣa lebḥeṛ (Wi d-yecfan i wasmi yerɣa lebḥeṛ?).
- Yenna-yas inisi: D nek i yas-tt-id-yellfen!
Yuɣal yečča iniɣem weḥd-s.

A Question of Age

Winter arrived: rain, wind, hail, and snow. One day, the wolf and the hedgehog went out together. They were hungry, searching for what they might eat. The autumn was over, during which the wolf had found figs as common as dirt on the ground and said: "Take back your bounty, O fig tree!" Now, when he passed under it, he said: "Blind me!" When he spotted a small cluster of grapes at the very top of a tree, he said: "Sour! Sour!"

They found a dried fig on the road, dropped by some shepherds. The hedgehog said to him:
— Let us divide it.
The wolf said to him:
— No! The one of us who is older in age shall eat it!
The hedgehog said to him:
— When were you born?
The wolf said to him:
— The day the sea burned (Who remembers the day the sea burned?).
The hedgehog said to him:
— It was I who kindled it for it!
And so, he ate the fig all by himself.

Kemmlen abrid, ufan aftat n tasa yeɣli-yas i walbeɛḍ n yemsewwqen. Yenna-yas wuccen d ablaḍ iwakken ad t-yečč weḥd-s. Yenna-yas inisi:

- D tasa kan: ad tt-nebḍu.
- Yenna-yas wuccen: Ala! A win meẓẓiyen deg-neɣ di leɛmeṛ ad t-yečč,
- Yenna-yas inisi: Melmi d-tluleḍ?
- Yenna-yas wuccen: iḍelli!
- Yenna-yas inisi: Ṭṭef-iyi-n ad n-laleɣ!

Yebda ad d-iteffeɣ si tebḍant-is. Yuɣal yečča daɣen tasa nni weḥd-s. Uccen yeqqim i laẓ, yeṭṭef-as-tt d tuḥsift.

They continued on their way and found a piece of liver dropped by someone returning from the market. The wolf said it was a flat stone so that he could eat it alone. The hedgehog said to him:

– It is just liver: let us divide it.

The wolf said to him:

– No! The one of us who is younger in age shall eat it!

The hedgehog said to him:

– When were you born?

The wolf said to him:

– Yesterday!

The hedgehog said to him:

– Hold me, I am about to be born!

He began to emerge from his skin. And so, he ate that liver all by himself again. The wolf remained hungry, harboring a bitter grudge against him.

Di tqellalt n lexliɛa

Yezla yiwen n wergaz axeṛfi d ameɛluf i lɛid tameqrant. Yečč seg-s ayen yečča netta d lwacul-is; ayen d-yeqqimen, icelleḥ-it, imelleḥ-it, fesren-t i yiṭij. Asmi yeqqur, terra-t tmeṭṭut di tqellalt, tesleɣ-itt.

In the Jar of Preserved Meat

A man had slaughtered a well-fattened lamb for the Great Eid. He and his family ate what they ate of it; what remained, he sliced, salted, and they spread it out in the sun. When it dried, the woman placed it into a clay jar and sealed it up.

Yiwwass, tedla fell-as, tufa-t ikcem-it buṣuf. Teddem taqellalt nni ɣer beṛṛa, tsers-itt i yiṭij, tṛuḥ tger tissirt n wawal nettat d tğaṛett-is. Igubeṛ-itt wuccen: uɣalen dduklen netta d inisi ad d-akren lexliɛa. Uccen yettuɛi, yečča armi yeṛwa; ɣas ar inisi, irfed-it wuccen, isers-it zdaxel n tqellalt: yečč ula d netta ayen i yas-yekteb Ṛebbi, lameɛna, s kra yeɛreḍ deg umeddakel-is ad t-id-yessufeɣ, yugi, Yenna-yas Si Mḥemmed:

- Ta di tin n yiḍelli, a Muḥend! Qqim din ar k-id-taf lalla-k: inisi, deg-s imensi!

- Yenna-yas inisi: Nek, lmut mmuteɣ, lameɛna ffreɣ agerruj: qerreb-d, ad ak-t-mleɣ, tferqeḍ-t keč d warrawiw.

- Yenna-yas wuccen: Anida? Anida?

- Yerra-yas-d inisi: Aha-t! Aha-t… ugerruj! Qerreb-d ameẓẓuɣ-ik!

Iqerreb-d tameẓẓuɣt-is wuccen: iḥuza-tt inisi s tuɣmas-is, iɣeẓẓa-tt. Ineggez Si Mḥemmed ɣer deffir, yedda-d Muḥend si tqellalt, yemneɛ. Ɣas ar tameṭṭut, seg wakken tugad ad tt-yennaɣ wergaz, tuɣ-itent mkemmda.

One day, she looked inside it and found that maggots had gotten into it. She took that jar outside, set it in the sun, and went to start a mill of words with her neighbor. The wolf was watching her: then he and the hedgehog joined together to go and steal the preserved meat. The wolf feasted first, eating until he was full; then it was the hedgehog's turn, so the wolf lifted him and placed him inside the jar. He too ate what God had written for him, but no matter how much he begged his companion to pull him out, he refused. Sir Mḥemmed said to him:

- This makes up for yesterday's trick, O Muḥend! Stay in there until your mistress finds you: a hedgehog makes a fine dinner!

- The hedgehog said to him: As for me, I am already dead, but I have hidden a treasure: come close, let me show it to you so you can divide it between yourself and my children.

- The wolf said to him: Where? Where?

– The hedgehog replied to him: Here it is! Here it is… the treasure! Bring your ear close!

The wolf brought his ear close: the hedgehog caught it with his teeth and bit into it. Sir Mḥemmed leaped backward, and Muḥend came out along with him from the jar, escaping safely. As for the woman, because she was so afraid her husband would beat her, she kept the whole matter hidden deep inside.

Di tdewwiṛt n tzizwa

Yiwwass, iṛuḥ inisi d wuccen ad d-akren tament si tdewwiṛt n tizizwa. Inisi yebna ad d-yerr seg wuccen ttaṛ n tqellalt n lexliɛa.

Ufan-n ad ilint meyya teɣrasin uqeccuc rsent f tqamtin, ɣumment s idilen d udellas, la therrew ddunit am temdint.

Xtaṛen yiwet n teɣrast d tameqrant ğeɛlen-tt teččuṛ d tament. Yuɣal yenna-yas wuccen:
- Qerreb, a Muḥend: keč meẓẓiyeḍ: ur k-id yettwali ḥed: tferseḍ-aɣ-d kra n tament.
Yenna-yas inisi: A Si Mḥemmed, nek afus-iw wezzi: ur ttuɛiɣ ara: ad qqimeɣ d aɛessas: kkes-aɣ-d keč kra n tḥedrin.

Yekkes wuccen s tuɣmas-is tadimt i teɣrast, yemmeɣ s ufus-is ɣer daxel ad d-yefres tament. Ẓẓgent-d deg-sen tizizwa d igelfan: uccen la teqqsent ireggel, yettsuɣu, yettemririɣ, armi t-rrant am uyeddid.

Inisi yerra taqerruct-is ɣer daxel, yeṛwa taḍsa: yuɣal ar yettegliliz, ineqq tizizwa yersen fell-as; armi yekfa, yebren fell-asent, yečča-tent, iṛuḥ ɣer cceɣl-is.

In the Bee Apiary

One day, the hedgehog and the wolf went to steal honey from a bee apiary. The hedgehog intended to get his revenge on the wolf for the matter of the jar of preserved meat.

They found what must have been a hundred bark hives resting on logs, covered with cork and thatch, making a roaring din like a bustling city.

They chose a large hive, assuming it was filled with honey. Then the wolf said to him:
— Go near, O Muḥend: you are small: no one will see you: gather us some honey.
The hedgehog said to him:
— O Sir Mḥemmed, my arm is too short: I can't reach: I will stay as a lookout: you pull out some combs for us.

The wolf pulled out the plug of the hive with his teeth and plunged his hand inside to gather the honey. The bees swarmed out upon them in massive clouds: the wolf fled as they stung him, screaming and rolling around, until they made him swell up like a waterskin.

The hedgehog tucked his head inside his shell and had his fill of laughing: then he rolled around on the ground, crushing the bees that had landed on him; when he was finished, he turned on them, ate them up, and went about his business.

Ɣas ar uccen, yeqqim geddac ur d-yeffiɣ si lɣar-is: issetḥa ad yemmẓer di liḥala nni: yecɛef. Seg wass nni, ur yuɣal ad as-yendi i inisi.

As for the wolf, he stayed for many days without coming out of his cave: he was ashamed to be seen in that condition: he had learned his lesson. From that day on, he never again tried to trap the hedgehog.

Taseqqart n jjwağ

Yiwwass, yennuɣ wuccen d tɛeggalt-is, ufrarent fell-as wallen-is, yebɣa ad iɛawed jjwağ. Icaweṛ inisi, yuɣal yesnejmeɛ-d lewḥuc, yenna-yasen:

- Ay atmaten, yessefk ad awen-mleɣ yiwet n lɛadda texṣer, di jjwağ, ad tt-nṣeggem. Acimi, d lemtel, awtul yettaɣ kan tawtult, aɣyul yettaɣ kan taɣyult, alɣem yettaɣ kan talɣemt? Annect agi, ur yelli d lḥeq wala d ṣṣwab. Yessefk-aneɣ ad nemxalaḍ di nnesba: wa ad yawi i wa tamusni neɣ lqed neɣ lğehd, ad tbeddel ccetla, ffɣen-d warraw nneɣ lhan irkel, ɛedlen irkel.

Si Mḥemmed d bab n wawal: lewḥuc, yufa-ten-id lḥal mseɛyan: qeblen-as lɛadda yagi tajdiṭ,

The Marriage Lottery

One day, the wolf quarreled with his wife, his eyes turned away from her, and he wanted to remarry. He consulted the hedgehog, then gathered the animals and said to them:

– O brothers, it is necessary that I show you a bad custom in marriage so that we may correct it. Why, for example, does a hare marry only a female hare, a donkey marry only a female donkey, and a camel marry only a female camel? This matter is neither just nor proper. We must intermarry across lineages: one will bring to another wisdom, or stature, or strength, so the breed will change, and our children will all come out fine and completely equal.

Sir Mḥemmed was a master of speech: the animals happened to be in agreement with him, so they accepted this new custom.

Uɣalen snejmeɛen-d tilawin, iger-asent inisi taseqqart. Mkul yiwen iṣaḥ-it-id wayen i t-id-iṣaḥen: uccen, tṣaḥ-it-id telɣemt: alɣem, tṣaḥ-it-id tuccent d taberkant d taqurant.

Yekker welɣem ad iberri: yenna-yas inisi:

- Yezla-k ccṛeɛ!

Yessusem, yewwi-yas wuccen tameṭṭut; ay inisi, yerban alɣem, uccen ixten-as.

Yefṛeḥ Si Mḥemmed s teslit agi tajdiṭ: ur teğği di lqed wala di lğehd wala di sshala; lameɛna iɛewweq di ṛṛay-is: teɣleb-it aṭas!

Then they gathered the females together, and the hedgehog cast lots for them. Each one was allotted what fell to his share: the wolf was allotted the female camel, while the camel was allotted the female wolf, who was black and dry.
The camel stood up to reject this, but the hedgehog said to him:
– The law binds you!
He fell silent, and the wolf took his wife; as for the hedgehog, he cradled the camel as the wolf performed the circumcision.

Sir Mḥemmed rejoiced with this new bride: she lacked nothing in stature, strength, or gentleness; however, he was utterly perplexed in his mind: she completely oversized him!

Tameɣṛa n wuccen

Yewqem wuccen tameɣra, ur igi taqbaylit ur d-yeqḍi i teslit, yeğğa-tt d tameɣbunt meskint: ur llin leεṛas, ur yelli nnwal, lḥaṣul d tameɣra tamessast.

Usan-d lewḥuc ad as-sbarken: tteklen ad ten-yessečč, ad d-kksen jjekk: ula d yiwen ur as-tebliɛ telqimt. Mi yas-yenna walbeεḍ: Mebṛuk tameṭṭut, a Si Mḥemmed! yerr-as-d: Ma tebrek! Akken armi d aneggaru.

At Ṛebbi umi ur yehwi ara jjwağ nni beggnen-t-id deg genwan: ixelṭ-d ugeffur d yiṭij d teslit n wanẓar d waḍu d lebraq d ṛṛɛud d webruri, armi ɣilen medden ad tenger ddunit.

The Wolf's Wedding

The wolf held a wedding feast, but he neither followed Kabyle custom nor provided for the bride, leaving her as a poor, neglected soul: there were no wedding processions, there was no cooking, in short, it was a completely tasteless wedding.

The animals arrived to offer their blessings: they counted on him to feed them so they could satisfy their hunger, but not a single one of them swallowed even a single morsel. When someone said to him: Congratulations on your new wife, O Sir Mḥemmed!, he replied to them: If she kneels! And so it went until the very last guest.

The people of God, who were displeased by that marriage, showed it in the skies: rain mixed with sun, rainbow, wind, lightning, thunder, and hail, until people thought the world was coming to an end.

Uɣalen ffɣen-d lewḥuc ɣer beṛṛa, bbehdeln uccen, la s-qqaren:

Ya laṭif! Ya laṭif!

Rwalut, rwalut!

Lehwa, tafukt!

Uccen yewwi-d tameṭṭut!

Rwalut, rwalut!

Ur aɣ-d-yefki taqessult:

Ad as-d-yefk Ṛebbi taqeẓẓult!

Uccen la ten-id yekkat s tqeslin tilmawin yerẓa irkel ijeqduṛen-is.

Ssyen, yelḥa d telɣemt armi d asmi yufa tɛedda-t: yerra-tt i tyerza: tameṭṭut n lɛali yettaɣ-itt yir rgaz, ur as-yessin ara leḥkaṛ-is!

Then the animals went outside, disgracing the wolf and chanting at him:
O Merciful God! O Merciful God!
Flee, flee!
Rain and sun!
The wolf has taken a wife!
Flee, flee!
He did not give us a bowl of food:
May God strike him with a tumor!

The wolf was throwing empty bowls at them, breaking all of his earthenware vessels.

From then on, he lived with the female camel until he realized she completely overpowered him: so he put her to the plow; a fine woman is often wed to a worthless man, who does not know her true worth!

Tafellaḥt n lleft

Yecrek wuccen tafellaḥt d inisi: uccen yefka-d talɣemt, inisi, taxxamt-is am tṛemmant, yefka-d zzerriɛa. Heggan-d lmiɛun, tagersa, tazaglutt, tafekkalt d ijebdan.

Asmi wten waman imezwura, begsen ɣer tfellaḥt n lleft. Qqnen talɣemt, zerɛen, bdan tayerza: inisi yerkeb f tsilett, uccen yeṭṭef agelzim.

Asmi tekfa tmazirt, bran, steɛfan. Lleft ye ur n-yensi deg wakal: deg wembrid yemɣi, yejbed tamezzurt.

The Turnip Field

The wolf entered into a farming partnership with the hedgehog: the wolf provided the female camel, and the hedgehog, whose home was as well-stocked as a pomegranate, provided the seed. They prepared the tools: the plowshare, the yoke, the wooden neck-collar, and the leather harness-straps.

When the first waters fell, they braced themselves for the cultivation of the turnips. They harnessed the camel, sowed the seed, and began plowing: the hedgehog rode upon the plow-tail to guide it, while the wolf held the pickaxe to break the clods.

When the field was entirely worked, they unyoked and rested. The turnip seed had sworn not to spend a single night in the earth: right away, it germinated and grew.

Ur yeqqim ara yebberber, yezzegzew am sserris. Asmi yewweḍ, yenna-yas inisi:

- Ad nejmeɛ lɣella nneɣ, ad tt-nefreq.

- Yenna-yas wuccen: Ala! Ssextaṛeɣ-k: awi ayen yellan nnig wakal neɣ ayen yellan ddaw wakal.

Tɛeğb-it tizzegzewt. Yenna-yas inisi:

- D acu ara tawiḍ?

- Yerra-yas-d wuccen: Nnig wakal!

- Yenna-yas inisi: Yirbeḥ! Tewwiḍ!

Yemmter wuccen tiwizi, temger-as irkel ifer nni. Asmi sellaw, iḍegger-it d aḍegger, yeffeɣ d lfareɣ. Imiren yuɣal inisi ad d-yeqqaz di tdeggar n lleft yessawaḍ ɣer texxamt armi teccuṛ.

It did not delay in spreading out, turning as green as grass. When it became ripe, the hedgehog said to him:
– Let us gather our harvest and divide it.
The wolf said to him:
– No! I give you the choice: take either what is above the earth or what is below the earth.
The wolf was charmed by the green foliage. The hedgehog said to him:
– What will you take?
The wolf replied to him:
– Above the earth!
The hedgehog said to him:
– It is a deal! You have taken it!

The wolf called together a communal work-party, and they reaped all of those leaves for him. When they withered, he flung them entirely away, ending up completely empty-handed. Meanwhile, the hedgehog began to dig out the turnip roots, carrying them to his home until it was stuffed full.

Tafellaḥt n nneɛma

Kkan ayen kkan, begsen ɣer tfellaḥt n nneɛma. Gan asudu: fetlen seksu s ibawen, dehnen-t s zzit armi yellexs; ɛerḍen-d widen i sen-yettilin, iḥbiben d lğiran. Ččan armi ṛwan ɣran-asen lfattiḥa.

Qqnen talɣemt, bdan lxedma. Mi d-ɛellmen taferka, zerɛen-tt d irden neɣ d timẓin. Ssyen, yiwen ad yeṭṭef lmiɛun, wayeḍ agelzim: aḍref yettabeɛ aḍref; ass yettabeɛ wayeḍ, armi tekfa taɣezzut s tyerza.

Tewweḍ-d tefsut, ssusun tafellaḥt; yewweḍ-d unebdu, tewwa. Ṛebbi yenna-d anɛam: ugar lḥeb alim.
Cellfen kra d arkul, ɛerḍen-t: ufan-t d lɛali-t.

The Grain Cultivation

After some time passed, they braced themselves to cultivate grain. They prepared the traditional plowing feast (asudu): they rolled couscous with fava beans and coated it with oil until it was thoroughly drenched; they invited their relatives, friends, and neighbors. They ate until they were full, and then they recited the opening prayer (lfattiḥa) for them.

They harnessed the female camel and began the work. Once they marked out the field, they sowed it with wheat or barley. After that, one would hold the plow-tail and the other the pickaxe: furrow followed furrow, day followed day, until the entire plot of land was completely plowed.

Spring arrived, and they weeded the crop; summer came, and it was ripe. God had granted abundance: more grain than straw. They plucked a few green ears and roasted them to make arkul, testing it: they found it to be excellent.

Asmi teqqur, yenna-yas inisi:

- Ad nejmeɛ rreẓq nneɣ qbel, ssyen ad t-nebḍu.

- Yenna-yas wuccen: Ala! Awi ayen yellan nnig wakal neɣ ayen yellan ddaw wakal.

- Yenna-yas inisi: Acu ara tawiḍ?

- Yerra-yas-d wuccen: Ddaw wakal! (Yebɣa ad d-yerr ttaṛ n tfellaḥt n lleft).

- Yenna-yas inisi: Yirbeḥ! Tewwiḍ!

Yewwi-d inisi tiwizi temger-as tafellaḥt-is, deg wembrid tcadd d tadliwin d irinen, tewweḍ s annar.

Yemmter wuccen tiwizi, lameɛna ur ufin ḥaca adellas d iẓuran.

Yeffeɣ-d dayen Si Mḥemmed d lfareɣ.

When it dried, the hedgehog said to him:
– Let us gather our provision first, and then we will divide it.
The wolf said to him:
– No! Take either what is above the earth or what is below the earth.
The hedgehog said to him:
– What will you take?
The wolf replied to him:
– Below the earth! (He wanted to get his revenge for the turnip field affair).
The hedgehog said to him:
– It is a deal! You have taken it!

The hedgehog called together a communal work-party, and they reaped his crop for him; along the way, it was bound into handfuls and then into larger sheaves, and it reached the threshing floor.

The wolf summoned a communal work-party as well, but they found nothing except weeds and roots. Once again, Sir Mḥemmed came out completely empty-handed.

Tazzala

Ibren-d wuccen s inisi, yenna-yas:
- Ay acrik, teccid lheq-iw, teswid tidi-w: ad neiwed bettu!
- Yenna-yas inisi: Yirbeh!

Uɣalen srewten, zzazedgen s tazzert d telweht: tbedd tirect n nneɛma, tayed ukerfa. Yenna-yas wuccen:
Ad d-nemzazzal si lmudeɛ leflani: a win d-yewwden d amezwaru s annar ad yawi tafellaht wehd-s.
- Yenna-yas inisi: Yirbeh!

Iniswen ttemcabin irkel. Yewwi-d Muhend kra n sin seg widen i s-yettilin: yiwen, yefka-t d wuccen ɣer lmudeɛ nni; wiyad, isers-iten deg umecwar. Netta d mmis aɛnan tirect s usaku d uqerwi.

The Race

The wolf turned to the hedgehog and said to him:
– O partner, you have eaten my share and drunk my sweat: we must divide it again!
The hedgehog said to him:
– It is a deal!

So they threshed and cleaned the crop with the pitchfork and the shovel: one pile of clean grain stood high, and another pile of chaff. The wolf said to him:
– Let us race from such-and-such a place: the one who arrives first at the threshing floor shall take the entire harvest for himself alone.
The hedgehog said to him:
– It is a deal!

Hedgehogs all look completely alike. Muḥend brought along a couple of his relatives: one he sent with the wolf to that starting point, and the others he stationed at intervals along the track. As for himself and his son, they stayed right by the grain pile with a large sack and a wooden measuring bucket.

Yemzazzal-d wuccen d umeddakel-is. Iṛuḥ-d Si Mḥemmed am waḍu: yeğğa-t-in; yuɣal yufa-t-id zdat-s, yeğğa-t-in. Yewweḍ s annar, la yesnukkuf, yettiqi si tidi: yufa-d inisi ɣer tirect n nneɛma, ṛwan lkil netta d mmis! La s-yeqqar:

- Seṭṭac, seṭṭac, sbeɛṭac! Naqel asaku, ay aqcic!

Yeffeɣ wuccen, bu meyya tḥila, ur yewwi si tirect wala si tednect!

The wolf ran the race against his companion. Sir Mḥemmed flew like the wind: he left him behind, but then he found another one right ahead of him and passed him again. When he finally reached the threshing floor, panting heavily and dripping with sweat, he found the hedgehog and his son right by the pile of grain, having their fill of measuring it! The father was saying to him:

– Sixteen, sixteen, seventeen! Shake the sack, my boy!

The wolf, master of a hundred tricks, walked away without taking a single grain or even a bit of chaff!

Tacekkukt n wudi

Yuɣ lḥal, qbel ad bdun tafellaḥt, uccen d inisi ffren tacekkukt n wudi. Mi d-mmektin yid-s, inin-as: Ad nekfu lxedma, ad neḥlu fell-as!
S kra tekka tyerza d wussay d tmegra d werwa, mi yeqqim inisi, ar deqqal, yerr awal amzun yella wi s-d-yessawlen:
- Anɛ ɛ ɛ am!

Imiren ad yeğğ uccen la ixeddem, ad iṛuḥ ad d-yečč kra si tzirett nni n wudi, ad d-yuɣal. Ma yas-d-yenna umeddakel-is: D acu akka, a Muḥend? yerr-as:
- Terna daɣen ɣur-i teqcict: nga-yas isem Mebda… Neɣ Mnaṣfa, neɣ Mmelqaɛ. Akken armi tekfa tcekkukt taseɛdit.

The Jar of Butter

It so happened that before they began farming, the wolf and the hedgehog hid a jar of butter. Whenever they remembered it, they would say: "When we finish the work, we shall feast upon it!" Throughout the plowing, the weeding, the harvesting, and the threshing, the hedgehog would suddenly answer back as if someone had called out to him:

— Yes-e-e-s!

Then he would leave the wolf working alone, go to eat some butter from that small clay pot, and return. If his companion asked him: What is it now, O Muḥend?, he would reply to him:

— Another baby girl has been born to me; we named her Beginning… Or Half, or Bottom. And so it went until that blessed jar was completely finished.

Asmi ɣnan, dlan fell-as, ufan-tt temmečč. Uccen la s-yeqqar:
- A Muḥend, d keč i tt-yečča! Ḥaca nekni i yeẓran anida tt-neffer!
- Inisi la s-yeqqar: D keč!
Uɣalen nnan:
- A win yečča udi, ad d-yeffeɣ yess: qbel ad neṭṭes, ad nsers d tama-tneɣ iceqfan a-nteffeɣ deg-sen: ad d-iban ṣṣeḥḥ!

Xedmen akkenni, lameɛna win yečča udi yuki: yekker deg yiḍ: ameddakel-is yeṭṭes: yuɣal ibeddel lmuḍeɛ i iceqfan.

Azekka nni, wa yeqqar i wa: D keč! Ur tefri gar-asen.

Iwala wuccen ulac llqeḍ di lǧeṛṛa inisi: yeṭṭaxer-as; mkul yiwen yuɣ abrid-is.

When they were done with the work, they went to check on it and found it had been eaten. The wolf said to him:
– O Muḥend, it was you who ate it! Only the two of us knew where we hid it!
The hedgehog kept saying to him:
– It was you!
Then they said:
– The one who ate the butter, it shall pass through him: before we sleep, we will place clay shards next to us to relieve ourselves into them, and the truth will be revealed!

They did exactly that, but the one who had eaten the butter was alert: he got up in the middle of the night while his companion was fast asleep and switched the positions of the shards.

The next morning, each one kept saying to the other: "It was you!" The matter could not be settled between them.

The wolf realized there was no profit left to gather from tracking the hedgehog: he distanced himself from him, and each one went his own way.

Argaz d wezrem

Yiwet n tṣebḥit, deg usemmiḍ la igezzem am lemqes, yeffeɣ wergaz ɣer lexla, Yufa-n azrem deg webrid yerẓa-t wegris. Iɣaḍ-it. Irfed-it, yerra-t s aqelmun-is. Akken d-yecreq yiṭij, teḥma tmurt, yetḥaya-d wezrem, yenneḍ-as i yiri, ixneq-it: ffɣent-d wallen-is. Yenna-yas wergaz:

- Dɛeɣ-k s Ṛebbi, a lxelq agi, ma ur iyi-tqaleḍ! Ufiɣ-k-id yerẓa-k wegris, ad k-ineɣ: sellkeɣ-k si lmut: d lxiṛ i k-xedmeɣ.

Yerra-yas-d wezrem:

- Anida yella lxiṛ i yi-txedmeḍ? Ffɣeɣ-d seg wemruj-iw n ddheb d lfeṭṭa, ad iyi-iwet wegris, iɛiwed-iyi yiṭij, iwakken ad sneṣleɣ taslest-iw, keč tewwiḍ-iyi-d! Amek ara afeɣ taxxamt-iw: tseɛreqḍ-iyi-tt! Tewwiḍ-d lmut: cehhed: ad temmteḍ!

Yenna-yas wergaz:

- Dɛaɣ-k s Ṛebbi, ma ur iyi-tefkiḍ ccṛeɛ.

Yefka-yas-t. Ṛuḥen s uccen, ḥkan-as, yenna-yasen:

- Ur ssineɣ i tigi: ṛuḥet s inisi.

The Man and the Serpent

One morning, in a cold that cut like scissors, a man went out to the wilderness. He found a serpent on the path, broken by the frost. He felt pity for him. He lifted him and put him into his hood. As soon as the sun rose and the land warmed up, the serpent came back to life; he coiled around the man's neck and choked him: his eyes bulged out. The man said to him:

- I implore you by God, O creature, spare me! I found you broken by the frost, about to kill you: I saved you from death; it was good that I did for you.

The serpent replied to him:

- Where is the good that you did for me? I came out of my burrow of gold and silver so the frost would strike me and the sun would follow, so that I could strip off my old skin, and you took me away! How will I find my room: you have made me lose it! You have brought death upon yourself: say your prayers, for you shall die!

The man said to him:

- I implore you by God, grant me a trial.

He granted it to him. They went to the wolf, told him their story, and he said to them:

- I know nothing of these matters: go to the hedgehog.

Akken wwḍen, yemmuqel-d deg-sen, yefhem ddeɛwa-nsen. Kkren ad ṣellin, yenna-yasen:
- Ala! ccṛeɛ igenni leɛmeṛ yelli! Keč, ay azrem, ers-d ɣer lqaɛa, qqim-d ssya, axṣim-ik ad yeqqim ssyen: mkul yiwen deg-wen ad d-icaṛeɛ, ad fruɣ gar-awen.

Akken d-yers wezrem ɣer lqaɛa, yendeh inisi f wergaz, yenna:
W'iṭṭfen aḥdif yawi lḥif:
A wer yebḍu d uɣilif!

Iwwet wergaz azrem, yebḍa-t mnaṣef: yeṭṭef aẓru, inɣed-as aqerru.

Yuɣal ibren-d ɣer deffir, yufa-d inisi yerwel, iwwet deg fassen-is, isuɣ:
- Ah! Yemneɛ imensi iɛeggalen!
W'ittamnen bnadem, aberkan uqerru!…

Di ddunit, ayen teẓẓiḍ, ad t-tɣellteḍ; bnadem, mi t-teẓẓiḍ, ad k-yeqleɛ!

As soon as they arrived, he looked at them and understood their case. They stood up to pray for judgment, but he said to them:

- No! A trial in the sky has never existed! You, O serpent, come down to the ground and sit here, and your opponent will sit over there: each one of you will plead his case, and I will settle it between you.

As soon as the serpent came down to the ground, the hedgehog urged the man on, saying:

He who holds a stick and suffers harm,
may he never be free from affliction!

The man struck the serpent and split him in half: he took a stone and crushed his head.

Then he turned back around, only to find that the hedgehog had fled. He clapped his hands in regret and shouted:

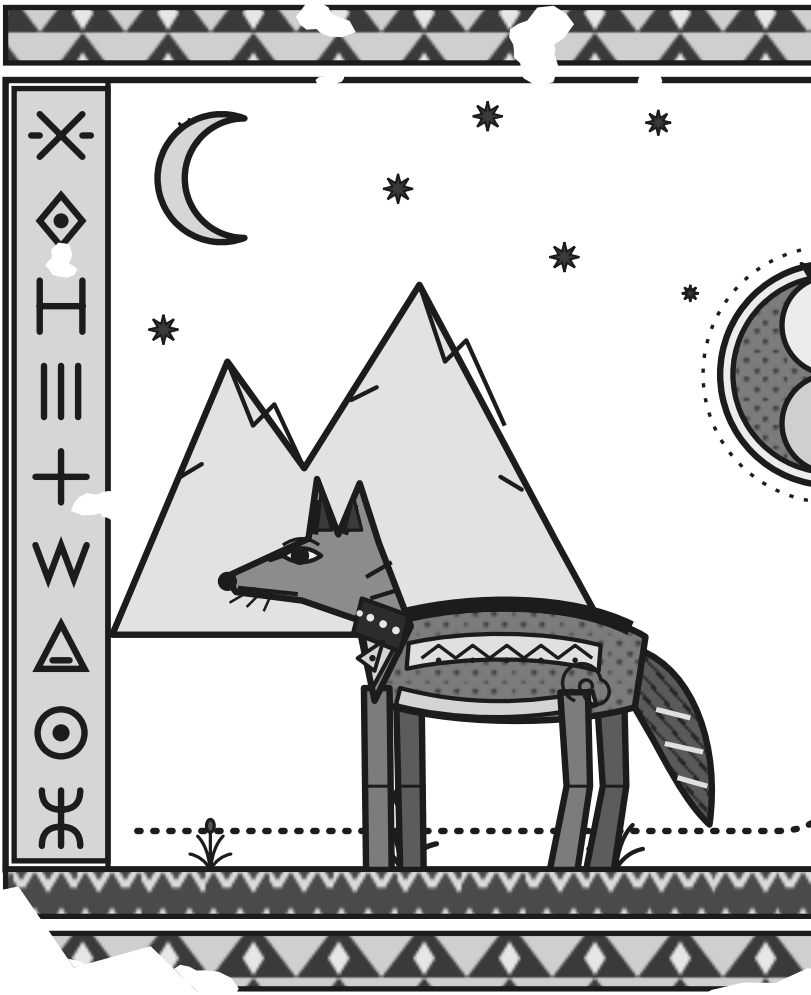
- Ah! The supper for my family has escaped!

He who trusts a human being, black-headed creature!…

In this world, what you plant, you shall harvest; but a human being, when you plant him, he roots you out!

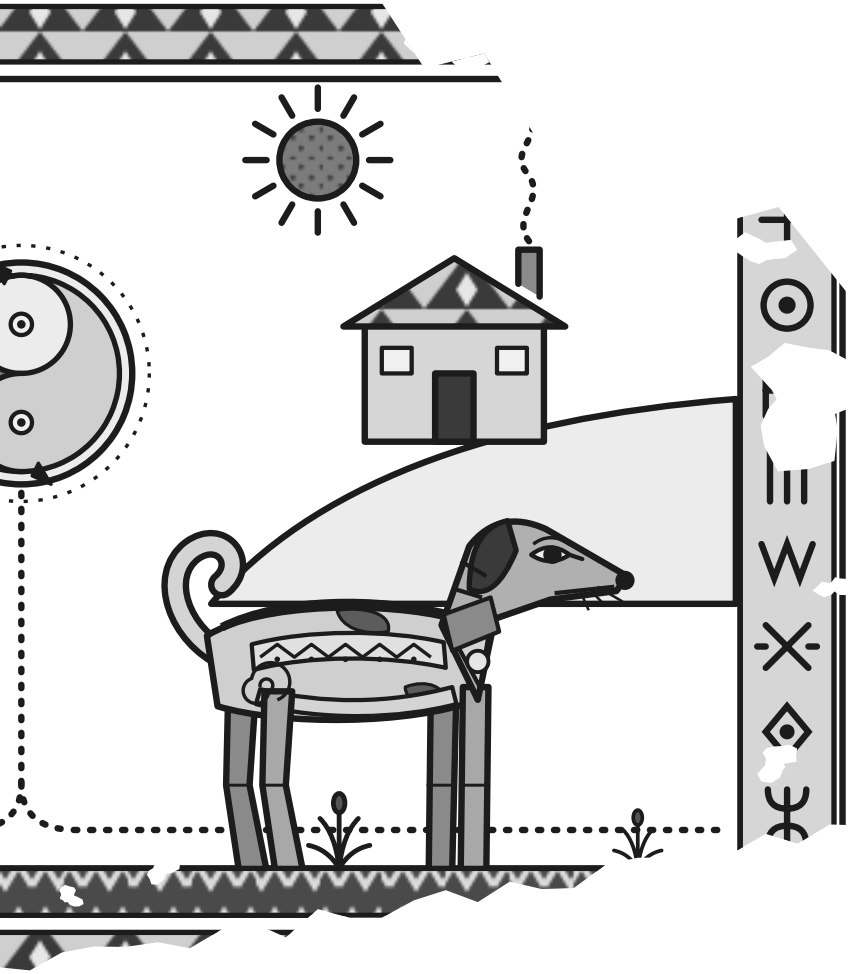
#3

Tamacahut n wuccen d wegdi



#3

The Tale of the Wolf and the Dog



Ɣef tbenɛemmett n wuccen d wegdi

Di ddunit taqdimt, uccen d wuccay llan d atmaten. Yiwen, isem-is Mḥemmed; wayeḍ, Rabeḥ, Kessen lmal weḥd-sen: ad brun ṣṣbeḥ, ad ksen ar tameddit, ad yeṛwu lmal, ad t-id-irren s axxam.

Assenni, ksan lmal, tuɣal tuccag tixsi deg yefri. Tsuɣ-d. Uccay, yufa-t-id lḥal yecɣel di lğiha nniḍen: yenna-yas wuccen:
- Ur ttagad!
Yers ad tt-id-isellek: yufa-tt-in tejreḥ. Yemceḥ idammen, yuɣal ikemmel-as: yenɣa-tt, yečča-tt.

Tameddit, mi d-bernen s axxam, uccay yedda-d di tlemmast n lmal, uccen ɛezlen-t akkin.

Yeqqim weḥd-s di teẓgi. Ussan imezwura, yeɣli-d fell-as yiḍ yendem deg wayen yexdem.

On the Ancient Feud Between the Wolf and the Dog

In the old world, the wolf and the hound were brothers. One was named Mḥemmed; the other, Rabeḥ. They pastured the livestock by themselves: they would let them out in the morning, pasture them until evening, and when the livestock was full, they would bring them back home.

That day, they pastured the livestock, and a ewe happened to slip into a cave. She cried out. The hound was occupied elsewhere at that moment, so the wolf said to her:

- Do not fear!

He went down to rescue her, but he found her wounded. He licked the blood, and then he finished her off: he killed her and ate her.

In the evening, when they returned home, the hound walked in the middle of the livestock, while the wolf was isolated far away.

He remained alone in the forest. During the first days, night fell upon him as he regretted what he had done.

Yiwwass, ibedd-d f yiwet n tiɣilt, yessawel-as-d i wuccay, yenna-yas-d:

Amarezg-ik, ay agdi:
La tegganeḍ ger wulli!

Yerra-yas wuccay
Ṛuḥ ssyenni!

D leɛmal-ik i wer nelhi:
Talli am kečč am nekkini!

Yerna-yas:

- Nek yid-k d atmaten: yiwet n tɛebbuṭ i yaɣ-yurwen: yya, meqqar, ad nemɛahad s Ṛebbi ur nemyučč!

Yenna-yas wuccay: ɛahdeɣ-k s Ṛebbi ur k-ččiɣ!

Yeḍsa fell-as wuccen, yerra-yas-d:

- Ɛahdeɣ-k s Ṛebbi ar anga k-ufiɣ, ard ad k-ččeɣ!

Ssyen, mkul yiwen yuɣ abrid-is.

Seg wass nni ay terṣa teɛdawt gar-asen, wala ger dderya-nsen.

One day, he stood upon a ridge, called out to the hound, and said to him:
Blessed are you, oh dog:
Sleeping in the midst of the sheep!
The hound answered him:
Go away from there!
It is your actions that are not good:
Otherwise, you would be just like me!
He added:

- You and I are brothers: the same belly gave birth to us: come, at least, let us swear by God not to eat one another!

The hound said to him: I swear to you by God that I will not eat you!
The wolf laughed at him and replied:

- I swear to you by God that wherever I find you, I will eat you!

From then on, each one took his own path.
It is from that day that the enmity was established between them, as well as between their offspring.

Uccen d taɣaṭ

Tenna-yas tixsi:

- Ad d-nnḍeɣ i tqejjiṛt-iw ad ṛwuɣ.

Tenna-yas taɣaṭ:

- Alamma kkiɣ-d sebɛa tmura ara ṛwuɣ.

Yiwwass, teffeɣ si teqḍeɛt tṛuḥ, deg uzal am yiḍ ɣer rrif n wasif. Iɛedda-d wuccen, iwala tili-s deg waman, iɣil d nettat. Ineggez ɣer temda ad tt-id-yeṭṭef, yufa ulac.

Yuɣal yeffeɣ-d, tḍehṛ-as sufella n tneqlett, la tɣeẓẓ.

Yenna-yas:

- Lḥemdu lilleh! Ɣileɣ, a weltma, tečča-kem temda: ers-d ad neddukel!

Terra-yas-d:

- Ugadeɣ ad iyi-teččeḍ, a Si Mḥemmed, ɛahed-iyi s Ṛebbi!

Iɛuhed-itt, ters-d dduklen.

The Wolf and the She-Goat

The ewe said:

- I only need to turn around my own leg to be full.

The she-goat said to her:

- Not until I cross seven countries will I be full.

One day, she left the flock and went, in the middle of the day like the dead of night, to the edge of the river. The wolf passed by and saw her reflection in the water; he thought it was really her. He leaped into the deep pool to seize her, but found nothing.

He came back out, and she appeared to him up on a fig tree, munching away.
He said to her:

- Praise be to God! I thought, my sister, that the deep pool had eaten you: come down so we can walk together!

She replied to him:

- I am afraid you will eat me, oh Sir Mḥemmed; swear to me by God!

He swore to her, and she came down to join him.

Uccen yezwar, taɣaṭ teḍfeṛ-it. Mi lḥan cwiṭ, ibren-d fell-as: yugad ad terwel. Yuɣal yenna-yas:

- La d-tesmejgareḍ tikli-w d tqejbabin-iw?

- Terra-yas: Ad iyi-yemneɛ Ṛebbi, a Si Mḥemmed! Ad zwireɣ.

Tuɣal tezwar, iḍfeṛ-itt wuccen. Mi yemmuqel di lefḥul-is la ceṭṭḥen, ar d-yettarew yimi-s aman. Yenna-yas:

- La yi-d-tesɣubburreḍ! Liwelli, la yi-d-tesmejgareḍ tura la yi-d-tesɣubbureḍ: ad kem-ččeɣ!

- Terra-yas: Ad iyi-yemneɛ Ṛebbi, a Si Mḥemmed: la yi-d-tettafeḍ kan tisebbiwin!

Armi i tt-yeẓẓemlal, tenna-yas:

- Ggall-iyi, teččeḍ-iyi!

- Yenna-yas: Anida?

- Tenna-yas: Di teẓrutt tamellalt.

La leḥḥun, armi wwḍen ɣer teẓrutt tamellalt, - din i yettqeggil lmal, - yeffeɣ-d ɣur-s wuccay: yerki-t, yesxenzer-it: yerwel. Teslek taɣaṭ tamcumt.

The wolf walked ahead, and the she-goat followed him. When they had walked a little, he turned back toward her: he was afraid she would escape. Then he said to her:

- Are you mocking my stride and my hind legs?

- She replied to him: May God preserve me, oh Sir Mḥemmed! Let me go ahead.

So she went ahead, and the wolf followed her. When he stared at her hindquarters bouncing as she walked, his mouth began to water. He said to her:

- You are kicking up dust at me! First you were mocking me, and now you are kicking up dust at me: I am going to eat you!

- She answered him: May God preserve me, oh Sir Mḥemmed: you are just looking for excuses against me! When he cornered her, she said to him:

- Swear to me, then eat me!

- He asked her: Where?

- She said to him: At the White Rock.

They kept walking until they reached the White Rock – the place where the livestock takes shelter from the heat– and the hound bounded out at him. He mauled him and left him looking wretched; the wolf fled. The cunning she-goat was saved.

Uccen d uḥuli

Yiwwass, teksa taɣaṭ nettat d sin iɣiden, tesɛa-ten-id yiwen d amenzu, wayeḍ d amalas.
Ixutel-iten-id wuccen, yemmeɣ-d fell-asen. Tqubel-it taɣaṭ s wacciwen-is: mi d-iqeddem s iɣiden, ad t-tberrez, ad iwexxeṛ akkin: arraw-is la teddun ger iḍarren-is, la tt-ttdarayen.

Yiwet n tikelt, ifureq-itt umenzu seg-sen, d aḥuli mɣint-as-d tacciwin: yekker-as d wul, yebɣa ad iberrez uccen ula d neṭṭa. Akken i t-iwwet, ifeṛṛed-it Si Mḥemmed, idhem-it s iɣẓer. Tetbeɛ-it taɣat, yuzzel-d wuccay. Lameɛna yufa-ten-id lḥal faten: ur ten-lḥiqen armi n-ufan ixneq-it wuccen, yerna yefka-yas kra n wuglan.

Kksen-as-t yemneɛ si lmut, lameɛna iẓur-d at laxeṛt. Yenna-yas wuccay:
- I k-yettawin, ay aḥuli, armi tettafgeḍ?

The Wolf and the Young Goat

One day, the she-goat was pasturing with her two kids, one of whom was her firstborn, and the other her youngest.
The wolf stalked them and leaped upon them. The she-goat confronted him with her horns: whenever he advanced toward the kids, she would charge him, and he would back away; her offspring kept moving between her legs, taking shelter under her.

At one moment, the firstborn separated himself from them—he was a young goat whose little horns were just growing, and he felt brave, wanting to charge the wolf himself. As soon as he struck at him, Sir Mḥemmed cut off his retreat and drove him down into a ravine. The goat rushed after them, and the hound came running. However, they found that it was already too late: they did not reach them until they found that the wolf had throttled him and given him several bites.

They snatched him away so he escaped death, but he had looked straight into the next world.
The hound said to him:
- What possesses you, oh young goat, to fly so high?

Uccen d tixsi

Yecrek wuccen tibḥirt d tixsi. Iɛuh-d-itt s Ṛebbi ur tt-yečč, ur yečči leḥq-is. Rẓan, ulsen, zerɛen llubyan. Wten waman, temɣi, tezzegzew am lebḥer.

Yewweḍ-d unebdu, tebda la tettiwriɣ: begsen ad tt-sswen; lameɛna teṣbeḥ-asen-d nnig tala, ur tt-tuɛi ara terga: uɣalen ar tt-sswan s ucekkuk.

Tixsi la tettagem, ifelleq wul-is; Si Mḥemmed la yesswa, yeddekkiṛ!

Tewweḍ-d lɣella: yella lxiṛ axlaf: lwin-d, sseɣren, ddzen; yeqqim-d ad ferqen. Yeddem-d wuccen taḍellaɛt; yuɣal, mi yektal setta i yiman-is, yektil tis sebɛa i tixsi, yin'as:
- Ad tt-tawi ɛemmti, ma yehwa-yas: nca-lleh, ur as-ihewwu ara!

The Wolf and the Ewe

The wolf partnered with the ewe to cultivate a vegetable garden. He swore to her by God that he would not eat her, nor would he take her rightful share. They broke the ground, ploughed it again, and sowed beans. The rains fell, the crop grew, and it turned as green as the sea.

Summer arrived, and the plants began to turn yellow. They prepared to water them; however, the garden sat higher than the spring, and a trench could not reach it. Consequently, they had to water it using a pitcher.

The ewe kept fetching the water until her heart was bursting, while Sir Mḥemmed watered and sang contentedly!

The harvest season arrived, bringing an abundance of crop. They gathered it, dried it, and threshed it; all that remained was to divide it. The wolf took a large basket. After measuring out six portions for himself, he measured a seventh for the ewe, saying:

- My aunt can take this, if she likes: God willing, may it not satisfy her!

Ur teqbil ara tixsi beṭṭu yagi: tenna-yas:
- Dɛaɣ-k s Ṛebbi, ma ur iyi-tefkiḍ ccṛeɛ.
Yefka-yas-t. Ṛuḥen mcaṛaɛen ɣer lewḥuc: yenna-yasen wuccen:
- Ay at leɛraḍ, amek ara d as-fkeɣ nnefṣ talli d nek i d-yettagmen, ifelleq wul-iw?
- Tenna-yasen: D lekdeb! D Si Mḥemmed umi n-teslam la yeddekkiṛ: win d-yettagmen ur yeddekkiṛ!

Inkeṛ-itt, abaden!
Tuɣal tṛuḥ tewwi-d uccay di teylewt, tsers-it f ccfeṛ n wennar. Iɣil wuccen d tanalt i yellan deg-s: iqeddem ad d-yeddem: ḍehrent-as wallen n wuccay la d-reqqent si zdaxel am nazir.

Yuɣal yefka lḥeq, yerna lbaṭel: mi yektal taḍellaɛt i yiman-is, yektil setta i tixsi, yin'as:
- Ɛemmti, meskint, aṭas ay teɛteb!

The ewe absolutely refused this division. She said to him:

- I appeal to you by God to grant me a trial.

He agreed. They went to seek judgment before the animals. The wolf said to them:

- Oh noble guests, how can I give half to her when I was the one fetching the water until my heart was bursting?

- She replied to them: It is a lie! It was Sir Mḥemmed whom you heard singing: anyone who is fetching water does not sing!

He denied it completely!

So she went and brought the hound inside a leather sack, placing it at the edge of the threshing floor. The wolf thought it was just a sack of grain resting there. He advanced to take it, but the eyes of the hound appeared, gleaming from inside like burning embers.

He quickly gave her what was fair and even what was not: while measuring one basket for himself, he measured six for the ewe, saying:

- My poor aunt, she labored so much!

Uccen d izimer

Yiwwass, yemlal wuccen d izimer ɣer terga n waman. Yenna-yas wuccen:

- Mṛeḥba yiss-k, a mmis n ɛemmti! D acu k-id-yewwin ɣer dagi?

- Yenna-yas izimer: D fad ay fudeɣ, a Si Mḥemmed: usiɣ-d ad sweɣ.

- Yenna-yas wuccen: Teskaddbeḍ! Kra ddaw uqerru-k! Yernu, yemma-k tečča lḥeq-iw n llubyan: yewwi-k-id Ṛebbi ad d-rreɣ ttaṛ-iw!

- Yenna-yas izimer: Acu ara teččêḍ deg-i, a Si Mḥemmend? Muqel: ala taglimt d tɣeswatin i yi-iɛemṛen! Sebru-yi kra n wagguren, ar d-nnerniɣ, ad d-qewwiɣ: ɛuhdeɣ-k s Ṛebbi ard ad d-uɣaleɣ!

Yunef-as, iṛuḥ, Yewweḍ ɣer yemma-s, yemla-yas.

Kkan ayen kkan, wwin uccay deg yesni, ṛuḥen armi d iɣẓer nni. Ata yusa-d wuccen. Akken d-iwala izimer, yezmumeg d taḍsa: yenna-yas:

- Keč d bu yiwen n wawal: tusiḍ-d ad k-ččeɣ…

- Yerra-yas izimer: Ggall-iyi f yesni yagi ar tečča yemma leɛtab-ik, teččeḍ-iyi.

The Wolf and the Lamb

One day, the wolf met the lamb near a stream of water. The wolf said to him:

- Welcome, son of my aunt! What brought you here?

- The lamb replied to him: It is thirst, I am parched, oh Sir Mḥemmed: I came to drink.

The wolf said to him: You lie! There is something under your head! Furthermore, your mother ate my share of the beans: God brought you here so I can take my revenge!

- The lamb said to him: What could you possibly eat on me, oh Sir Mḥemmed? Look: nothing but skin and little bones fill my body! Grant me a few months until I grow and become strong: I swear to you by God that I will return!

He let him go, and the lamb went away. He reached his mother and told her everything.

Some time passed, and they carried the hound inside a large wicker basket, going down to that same ravine. Behold, the wolf arrived. As soon as he saw the lamb, he beamed with a smile and said to him:

- You are a man of one word: you have come so I may eat you…

- The lamb replied to him: Swear upon this wicker basket that my mother ate the reward of your hard labor, and then you may eat me.

Yerfed wuccen taqejjiṛt-is, isers-itt f yesni ad yeggall: yemmeɣ-d fell-as wuccay, iɣeẓẓa-tt. Yebda wuccen la yeskeɛwiw, lameɛna ur as-yebri armi iḥuza irkel iman-is.

Yebren Si Mḥemmed ɣer texxamt-is f tlata iḍarren: yeslek izimer abaḥan.

The wolf raised his paw and placed it on the basket to swear: the hound lunged at it and bit it. The wolf began to yelp and howl, but the hound did not let go until the wolf had completely soiled himself.

Sir Mḥemmed turned back to his den on three legs; the lovely lamb was saved.

Uccen d uyaẓiḍ

Yiwwass, yunag wuccay d uyaziḍ inig ameqran.
Ḍallen i idurar d iɣallen, zegren isaffen, qegglen di tɣezza d tluta. Ass-nni, yeɣli-d fell-asen yiḍ di teẓgi. Ayaziḍ yuli f tasaft d taɛlayant: uccay yekcem s uruz ad yeddari, yeqqim d aɛessas.

Akken d-izewweq lefjer, ihuzz uyaziḍ afriwen-is, yebda la yesɣuggu. Mazal werɛed yekfi, yewweḍ-it-id wuccen ɣer lǧedra, yenna-yas:
- Ttbarik lleh di taɣect i k-yefka Ṛebbi! A win i s-d-yeslan ad yiḥnin wul-is, ad yejjem taẓallit: akken d-yeṣbeḥ ṣṣut-is deg umeẓẓuɣ-iw, ndekwaleɣ-d seg yiḍes, uzzleɣ-d.
Tura, a lḥağ, imi tekfiḍ tuddna, ers-d an neẓẓal.

Ixẓer-it-id uyaziḍ, yefhem belli mačči d ṭṭaɛa n Ṛebbi i t-id-yewwin: d aqerru-s kan i yebɣa ad t-iɣeẓẓ.
Yerra-yas-d:
- A-t-an wemṛabeḍ deg wuruz: ssaki-t-id si meɛḍil ad n-rseɣ!

The Wolf and the Rooster

Once, the hound and the rooster went on a long journey. They looked out over mountains and ridges, crossed rivers, and halted in fields and vales. That day, night fell upon them in a forest. The rooster flew up onto a tall oak tree, while the hound went into a hollow space to shelter himself and remained there as a guard.

As the dawn began to color the sky, the rooster shook his wings and started crowing. Before he had even finished, the wolf came to the foot of the tree and said to him:

- Blessed be God for the voice He has given you! Whoever hears it, his heart will soften and he will perform his prayer. As soon as your voice struck my ear this morning, I woke up from my sleep and ran over. Now, O Pilgrim, since you have finished the call to prayer, come down so that we may pray.

The rooster looked down at him and understood that it was not the devotion to God that had brought him, but that he simply wanted to crunch his head. He replied to him:

- The holy man is right there in the hollow. Wake him up while I come down!

Iga akka Si Mḥemmed s uruz yellan di lğedra, iḍehr-as wuccay yeṭṭes: iɛawez ağel n yiḍ d aɛessas, iḥwes-as-tent nadam s udem n ṣṣbeḥ.
Yebda wuccen la yettergigi, yeqqar i uyaziḍ:
- Ṛğu, ṛğu! ad d-sebɣeɣ luḍu ad d-uɣaleɣ!
Yennser am wezrem deg usaɣur, yeṭṭef abrid-is, iṛuḥ.

Sir Mḥemmed looked toward the hollow in the tree and saw the hound sleeping: he had watched all night as a guard, and sleep had overcome him towards the morning. The wolf began to tremble and said to the rooster:

- Wait, wait! Let me perform my ritual ablutions and I will return!

He slipped away like a snake into the dry grass, took to his path, and left.

Izem d wergaz

Yiwwass iṛuḥ wergaz s uccen, yenna-yas:
- A Si Mḥemmed, yesnegr-iyi yizem lmal-iw: ur as-zmireɣ, ur as-yezmir wuccay: ad tḍebbreḍ fell-i, ad ak-fkeɣ leḥq-ik.
- Yenna-yas wuccen: Yella war, yella ddebb-is!

Mesewwaqen s izimer iqewwan, mɛahaden s Ṛebbi ur myexdeɛen.

Yeččuṛ-d wuccen taylewt n tizit tatiṭuḥt yettilin d igelfan deg welmaten. Yekkat-itt yizem s tuɣmas-is, tkeččem-as deg meẓẓuɣen d lemnaxeṛ, tessufuɣ-it si lɛeql-is wala si teẓgi, iteddu am umehbul.

Yefka wuccen taylewt nni, i wergaz, yesmar-itt tameddit deg wemṛaḥ.

Akken d-ineggez yizem, yufa-d tizit teččuṛ afrag. Yuɣal yeffeɣ-it leɛqel, yeẓẓel am uzeqqur, la yettergigi am yifer.

Yeddem-d ɣur-s wergaz ameslut d azegzaw, yekker-as armi i s-yesseww aɛrur-is, yunef-as, iṛuḥ.

The Lion and the Man

One day, the man went to the wolf and said to him:

- O Sir Mḥemmed, the lion is destroying my livestock. Neither I nor the hound can do anything against him. If you find a solution for me, I will give you your reward.

- The wolf replied to him: The lion exists, but so does his master!

The deal was struck over a plump lamb, and they swore by God not to betray each other.

The wolf filled a sack with those tiny stinging gnats that gather in swarms in the marshlands. When the lion snaps at them with his teeth, they get into his ears and nostrils, driving him out of his mind and out of the forest, making him run around like a madman.

The wolf gave that sack to the man, who emptied it in the evening inside the courtyard.

As soon as the lion leapt in, he found the courtyard full of gnats. He lost his senses, stretched out on the ground like a log, and began to tremble like a leaf.

The man grabbed a fresh wooden cudgel, went at him until he thoroughly thrashed his back, then let him go, and the lion left.

Yecɛef yizem: seg wass nni, ur d-yuɣal.

Ɣas ar tameṭṭut, tenna: d lɛali ssuq fell-i! Ayen d-yeğğa lmir n lewḥuc, ad t-ikemmel Si Mḥemmed!

Tuɣal, di lɛuḍ ara terr, akken tt-iweṣṣa wergaz, izimer di teylewt, terra uccay.

Yewwi wuccen taylewt. Armi d abrid yesteɛfa, yefsi-yas iciddi: yeffeɣ-d ɣur-s wuccay, yerki-t, yesxenzer-it irkel.

Yenna-yas Si Mḥemmed: Lxiṛ mesḍir d aqdim! Yernu, yenna-t winna n zzman: Tamellalt n tmeṭṭut, d talɣemt i tt-id-yettarwen!

The lion was corrected; from that day on, he never returned.

As for the wife, she said to herself: More than I bargained for! What the king of the animals spared, Sir Mḥemmed will finish off!

Instead of putting what her husband had instructed—the lamb in the sack—she put the hound inside.

The wolf carried the sack away. Once on the road, he stopped to rest and untied the knot. The hound sprang out at him, mauled him, and tore him all over.

Sir Mḥemmed said: A good deed brings misfortune! Indeed, as the ancient saying goes: An egg belonging to the woman was laid by a female camel!

Izem d tmeṭṭut

Yiwwass, terfed tmeṭṭut taqabact, d temrart, ṭruḥ ɣer teẓgi ad d-tezdem. Seg wakken i tt-yenɣa lḥif n yesɣaren, la tzeddem, tettruẓu, tetterra di rrif, armi tessaweḍ tazdemt annect n wi tt-ila Ṛebbi.

W'ara tt-icidden? W'ara tt-issiwḍen s axxam? Tuɣal teqqim ɣer lqaɛa, teṭṭef lḥenk-is, ar tettxemmim.

Yufa-tt-id yizem, yenna-yas:
- A yemma tamɣart, d acu akka kem-yuɣen?
Tuɣal teḥka-yas lḥif deg tella. Teḥka-yas irkel, ssya u ssya, terna teḥka-yas tamsalt n wuccen d teylewt d ttar i s-terra: tɣaḍ-it. Yuɣal icadd tazdemt, yerra-tt f weɛrur-is, yesserkeb tameṭṭut zdeffir-s, ṛuḥen armi tawwurt n wexxam.

The Lion and the Woman

One day, the woman picked up a small axe and a rope, and went to the forest to gather wood. Because she was so worn out by the hardship of gathering firewood, she kept gathering, breaking, and setting it aside in a pile, until she had made a bundle as large as God could make it.

Who was going to bind it? Who was going to bring it home? So she sat back down on the ground, held her cheek in her hand, and fell into deep thought.

The lion found her there and said to her:

- O old mother, what is the matter with you?

She then related to him the hardship she was in. She told him everything, from this side and that, and she also recounted the matter of the wolf and the leather bag and the revenge she had taken for him; he felt pity for her. Then he bound the bundle of wood, placed it on his back, mounted the woman behind him, and they went all the way to the door of the house.

Tameṭṭut tessekcem tazdemt, izem imekken tameẓẓuɣt-is ger ccqayeq.
Mmuqlen at wexxam di tezdemt, mačči d ayen ara d-tsellkeḍ: steqsan tameṭṭut: teḥka-yasen. Nnan-as:
- D acu ara tiniḍ di lmir n lewḥuc?
- Tenna-yasen: D argaz n lɛali, meɛna i yettfuḥ nnefs-is!

Akken yesla yizem i wannect agi yenneḥcam, yennezrureḍ, iṛuḥ.

Iɛedda wayen iɛeddan, tebren tmeṭṭut ɣer teẓgi ad d-tezdem. Yaf-itt-id yezem: yenna-yas:
- Wet-iyi-d s tqabact s anyir!
- Terra-yas: Ur zmireɣ: txedmeḍ-iyi lxiṛ!
- Yenna-yas: Ad iyi-d-tewteḍ, neɣ ad kem-ččeɣ.
Tuɣal tewt-it s tqabact ɣer ger wallen. Iṛuḥ la yeskeɛwiw, yezzazzal idammen.

The woman brought the bundle of wood inside, while the lion placed his ear between the cracks of the door. The people of the house looked at the bundle of wood—it was not something you could easily get away with bringing: they questioned the woman, and she narrated to them. They asked her:

- What do you say about the king of the animals?

- She told them: He is a good man, but how his breath stinks!

As soon as the lion heard this, he felt deeply ashamed, slunk away, and left.

After some time had passed, the woman returned to the forest to gather wood. The lion found her there and said to her:

- Strike me with the axe on the forehead!

- She replied to him: I cannot; you did a good deed for me!

- He told her: You will strike me, or I will eat you. So she struck him with the axe right between the eyes. He left whimpering, making the blood run.

Kkan ayen kkan, yufa-tt-id dayen di teẓgi la tzeddem. Yenna-yas:

- Ani-yi-d.

Tuɣal ar as-tettani, armi i d-temlal ccama n tyita-s, ger wallen. Tenna-yas:

- Lḥemdu Lleh, a mmi, aql-ak-id teḥliḍ!

- Yenna-yas: Leğruḥ qqazen, ḥellun; imeslayen qqazen, rennun!

Yuɣal yemmeɣ fell-as, yečča-tt.

After some time had gone by, he found her again in the forest gathering wood.

He said to her:

- Delouse me.

So she began delousing him, until she came across the scar of her blow between his eyes. She said to him:

- Praise be to God, my son, you are healed!

- He said to her: Wounds dig and heal; words dig and multiply! Then he sprang upon her and ate her.

Tamsalt n nnesba

Yewweḍ wuccen ɣer texxamt-is di yir ḥala. Tdiwa-t tuccent geddac d wamek yeḥla. Tuɣal tenna-yas:

- Yya, ay argaz, ad n-ḍebbreɣ. Iḍen d atmaten nneɣ: ɣer-neɣ aqcic, ɣer-sen taqcict: ad ten-nsemyejwağ, ad temsu teɛdawt gar-aneɣ.

- Yerra-yas: Atmaten d atmaten, aɛebbuḍ iferq-iten. Ur aɣ-ttnasaben ara.

Armi i t-teḥṛes, yenna-yas:

- Ṛuḥ kem ɛreḍ-d iman-im!

Tcebbeḥ tuccent, tnawel, tṛuḥ ad d-texḍeb. Akken tewweḍ, ffɣen-d ɣur-s. Tberra, tenna:

- D nnesba n Ṛebbi i yi-d-yewwin!

Ur as-ssemḥessen ara: bezbazen-tt-id, iṛuḥ nnwal nni d abbu; sxenzeren-tt irkel: i tt-id-imenɛen d iḍarren-is.

The Matter of Alliance

The wolf arrived at his den in a terrible state. The she-wolf nursed him back to health through much effort. Afterward, she said to him:

- Come, husband, let me propose a plan. The dogs are our brothers: we have a boy, and they have a girl. Let us marry them to one another, and the enmity between us will be wiped away.

- He replied to her: Brothers are brothers, but the womb divides them. They will never accept an alliance with us.

Only when she relentlessly pressed him did he say to her:

- Go on then, try it yourself!

The she-wolf dressed herself up, prepared a meal, and went out to propose the marriage. As soon as she arrived, they came out against her. She protested, saying:

- It is an alliance in the name of God that has brought me here!

They did not listen to a word she said: they fell upon her and tore at her, that prepared meal went up in smoke, and they all fiercely mangled her; she owed her survival only to her legs.

Yufa-tt-id wuccen ɣer lkanun la tteqqed tiyitwin s tmes. Yemmuqel-itt, temmuqel-it-id: ur as-yenni, ur as-d-tenni. Teṛwa ṛṛay-is weḥd-s.

The wolf found her by the hearth, cauterizing her wounds with fire. He looked at her, and she looked back at him: he said nothing to her, and she said nothing to him. She had fully tasted the consequences of her own counsel.

Lmut n wuccay

Yeqqim wuccen d yiman-is, yenna: Ya ɛğaba! Lewlegga iṛuḥen ɣer nnesba n Ṛebbi, d iḍarren-is i tt-id-imenɛen, talli wissen acu ara yid-s yeḍrun! Tagi d taneggarut nek d wuccay.

Ayen yekkan fell-as irkel, qbel ass nni, ur as-iḥulfa akken iḥulfa i sser d-yettwakksen f tɛeggalt-is. Seg wakken ur as-yezmir ara i wegdi s yiɣil-is, ijbed-d tamusni d yifis, uday! aneggaru di lxalayeq! Uɣalen d imeddukal, ečč-n, teččeḍ-d.

Yiwwass, iru-yas tameḍrurt d lḥif yekkan fell-as, yenna-yas:
- Ad iyi-tɛiwneḍ deg wuccay, ad d-rreɣ seg-s ttaṛ: ad ak-fkeɣ leḥq-ik.

Iqbel-as ufuḥan. ɛassen-t armi d asmi i s-ufan asulef, qesden-t. Uccen yessleqḍ-it-id, iffis yewt-it, yenɣa-t: ččan-t.

The Death of the Hound

The wolf sat by himself and said: How astonishing! The delicate one went for an alliance in the name of God, and it was only her legs that saved her; who knows what could have happened to her! This is the end between me and the hound.

Of everything that had ever happened to him before that day, he had never felt anything like the blow to his honor regarding his wife. Because he was not strong enough to face the dog by brute force, he drew upon an acquaintance with the hyena –a wretched outcast! The lowest of all creatures! They became companions, eating together.

One day, he lamented to him the misfortune and hardship that had befallen him, saying:
- Help me against the hound so I can take my revenge on him, and I will give you your share.

The foul-smelling beast accepted. They watched him until they found an opportunity, and they went after him. The wolf lured him out, and the hyena struck him down and killed him; they ate him.

Ssyenna, nehṛen-d lmal, armi d abrid mlalen-d d yizem. Uccen ijelleb, yerwel. Iffis, yuɣ seg-s Ṛebbi lḥeq: yewt-it yizem, yerẓa-t di tbaqit n wammas, yeğğa-t. Asmi yeḥla, yenqes uḍar-is yeqqim d aɛewẓal, segmi i s-qqaren d bu tlata iḍarren.

Akka i yemmut wuccay meskin, yettɛassan lmal agugam. Isewweq deg-s gma-s, yenɣa-t yiffis ur nesɛi nnif! Seg wass-nni i yendeq lxiṛ.

From there, they drove away the livestock, until along the road they crossed paths with the lion.
The wolf leaped away and fled. As for the hyena, God took justice from him: the lion struck him, breaking the small of his back, and left him. When he healed, his leg was shortened and he remained lame, which is why people call him the three-legged one.

That is how the poor hound died, he who used to guard the mute livestock.
His own brother plotted against him, and he was killed by the hyena who has no honor! It is from that very day that goodness vanished.

Uccen d tmelqubeɛt

Yiwet n tmelqubeɛt tga lɛecc-is deg yefri. Turew deg-s tezdel, tsefṛuṛx-d ifṛax. Ssyen, segmi ara d-yenqer yiṭij alamma yeɣli di lebḥeṛ, deg uzal am tmes, nettat a-tt-an tṛuḥ, a-tt-an tuɣal-d, tesselqaḍ arraw-is.

Ass nni, iɛedda-d wuccen, iwala-tt, yesla i yefṛax-is la ččewčiwen. Yenna-yas:

- Ḍegger-d yiwen, neɣ ard n-aliɣ!

Tebda tmelqubeɛt tiyita n lizar, temmeɣ-d fell-as, ad t-tenqeb. Yuɣal wuccen ar idess:

- Mačči d Si Mḥemmed umi ttkellixen! Ḍegger-d yiwen, neɣ ard n-aliɣ!

Teṭṭef yiwen si tqejjiṛt, tḍegger-as-t-id: yečča-t, iṛuḥ.

Azekka nni yuɣal-d, yenna-yas:

- Ḍegger-d yiwen, neɣ ard n-aliɣ!

Tḥawet, tru, ulac! Teṭṭef yiwen si tferrett, tḍegger-as-t-id: yečča-t, iruḥ.

Teqqim tmelqubeɛt la tettru idammen, tezza tasa-s.

The Wolf and the Lark

A certain lark made her nest in the hollow of a rock. She laid her eggs there in abundance, and hatched her chicks. From then on, from the rising of the sun until it set into the sea, in the midday heat like fire, there she was, going out and coming back, gathering food for her children.

That day, the wolf passed by, saw her, and heard her chicks chirping. He said to her:

- Throw one down to me, or else I will climb up!

The lark began her alarm cry, fluttering wildly down upon him to peck at him. Then the wolf began to laugh:

- It is not Sir Mḥemmed who is so easily fooled! Throw one down, or else I will climb up!

She took one of them by the leg and threw it down to him; he ate it and left.

The next day he returned and said to her:

- Throw one down to me, or else I will climb up!

She begged, she cried, but it was no use! She took one of them by the wing and threw it down to him; he ate it and left.

The lark remained there weeping tears of blood, her heart utterly broken.

Iɛedda-d ibellireğ, yufa-tt-id di yir ḥala. Yenna-yas:
- D acu kem-yuɣen, a weltma?
Teḥka-yas f lbaṭel yekkan fell-as d lḥif deg tella.
Yenna-yas:
- Ikellex-ikem bu tḥila: Lukan yezmir ad n-yali, talli i m-ten-yečča irkel deg yiwet n tikelt. Lameɛna, anga s-temmaleḍ!
Yuɣal iṛuḥ ɣer cceɣl-is.

Azekka nni, yusa-d Si Mḥemmed, yenna-yas:
- Ḍegger-d yiwen neɣ ard n-aliɣ!
Tugi. Iɛecca yessagad, yettagges s uberwaq, yettcebbib deg yefri: ur d-yeqḍi ara. Tamelqubeɛt, d nneyya, tenna-yas:
- Ṛuḥ f yiman-ik: yekfa ukellex! Yenna-yi ɛemmi ibellireğ ur tezmireḍ ara ad d-taliḍ: ad k-yexdeɛ Ṛebbi akken i yi-txedɛeḍ deg warraw-iw!
Yerra-yas wuccen:
- Ah! d bu iɛejquren i kem-yesḥeṛcen? Anef-as ar t-ṭṭfeɣ, bu iɛefnaḍ: ad as-mleɣ!
Netta iṛuḥ: tamelqubeɛt tɛeggen-as i ibellireğ.

The stork passed by and found her in a terrible state. He said to her:

- What is the matter with you, sister?

She related to him the injustice that had befallen her and the hardship she was in.

He told her:

- The trickster has fooled you! If he were able to climb up, he would have eaten them all at once. But whatever you do, do not show him that you know!

Then he went about his business.

The next day, Sir Mḥemmed arrived and said to her:

- Throw one down to me, or else I will climb up!

She refused. He tried everything to terrify her, making a show of climbing while rustling the asphodel stalks and scaling the rock, but he accomplished nothing. The lark, in her innocence, said to him:

- Go on your way; the fooling is over! Uncle Stork told me you are unable to climb up. May God betray you just as you betrayed me regarding my children!

The wolf replied to her:

- Ah! So it is that long-legged one who made you clever? Just let me catch him, that eater of filth: I will show him!

He left, and the lark immediately sent warning to the stork.

Ibellireğ d yemqerqren

Iṛuḥ wuccen s imqurqren ad asen-d-yessebges, ad xlun ibellireğ. Yenna-yasen:

- Ay atmaten, yečča-d tasa nnwen ibellireğ: la ttmettaten warraw nnwen ur asen-teččuṛ. Amek tqeblem ccɣel agi, talli netta weḥd-s, kenwi ur ken-ikeffu ara ujenwi? Nnan-as:

- Ixuṣṣ-aɣ ṛṛay. Ḍebber fell-aɣ, a Si Mḥemmed.

Yuɣal yesnejmeɛ-iten deg yiḍ: wten lluɣa-nsen: qwer! qwer! qwer! Mkul yiwen yemmesli-d ayen d-yemmesli, armi mtafaqen f yiwen n wawal: Azekka ad nexlu ɛemmi ibellireğ!

The Stork and the Frogs

The wolf went to the frogs to rouse them, so that they would destroy the stork. He said to them:

- O brothers, the stork has eaten your very liver: your children are dying before their time is full. How can you accept this state of affairs, when he is all alone, while a whole valley would not be enough to contain you all?

They said to him:

- We lack wise counsel. Guide us, O Sir Mḥemmed.

So he gathered them together in the night: they struck up their language: croak! croak! croak! Each one spoke what they had to speak, until they agreed upon a single word: Tomorrow we will destroy Uncle Stork!

Azekka nni, begsen ɣer lfetna, ferqen d tiɣugga. Akken d-yers ibellireğ deg wasif, qeddmen ɣur-s s tiẓẓift. Yuɣ lḥal, yiwen seg-sen, d bab n nnif, d bab n yiɣil, yezwar zdat-sen am gellid zdat lemḥella. Yemmeɣ-d fell-as ibellireğ s umenqar-is, yeṭṭef-it, wexxṛen wiyaḍ. Yuɣal ar d-yettissix:

- Abbuh! ay atmaten! Annaɣ, mačči akka i nenna!

Ur as-ḥessen ara: rewlen s imerjan-nsen, am wudayen. Mkul yiwen, mi yeɣmes di temda, yin'as: Amcum b ṛas-u! Amcum b ṛas-u!

Yewwi ibellireğ bab n nnif nni ɣer lɛecc-is, yesxenzer-it: ččan-t warraw-is. Qqimen-d imqerqren am wezduz ur nesɛi afus.

the next day, they equipped themselves for strife and divided into teams. As soon as the stork landed in the river, they advanced toward him with low croaking murmurs. As it happened, one among them, a master of honor and a master of strength, marched ahead of them like a king before his army. The stork lunged down upon him with his beak and seized him; the others drew back. Then he began to wail:

- Mercy, O brothers! By God, this is not what we agreed!

They did not listen to him: they fled back to their swamps, scattered like cowards. Each one, as they dived deep into the pool, said: Let the wretched one look out for his own head! Let the wretched one look out for his own head!

The stork carried that master of honor to his nest and tore him apart; his children ate him. The frogs were left behind like a mallet that has no handle.

Uccen d ibellireğ

Ur as-igi ara ibellireğ i wuccen ard as-iɛawed tandit. Iɛass-it: armi t-yesseɣfel, yemmeɣ fell-as, iḥuza-t seg uselsul uzagur, yufeg yess, irfed-it deg genwan.

Ar itenneḍ yettali, itenneḍ yettali, armi i d-ixella idurar ɛlayen. Imiren, yenna-yas:

- D acu twalaḍ, a Mḥemmed?

- Yerra-yas-d wuccen: Idurar, izuɣar, isaffen: atna irkel ddawa-tneɣ!

Yerna yuli yess, yenna-yas:

- D acu twalaḍ?

- Yerra-yas-d: Yeɣli-d calwaw f wallen-iw: ur frizeɣ ara mliḥ tamurt!

Yerna yuli yiss, yenna-yas:

- I tura, acu twalaḍ?

- Yerra-yas-d: Nxella-d asigna!

The Wolf and the Stork

The stork did not give the wolf time to prepare another trap for him. He watched him until he caught him off guard, lunged at him, gripped him by the spine of his back, flew up with him, and carried him into the heavens.

He kept circling and rising, circling and rising, until he had left the high mountains far below. Then, he said to him:

- What do you see, O Mḥemmed?

- The wolf replied to him: The mountains, the plains, the rivers—there they all are beneath us!

He rose with him even higher and said to him:

- What do you see?

- He replied to him: A dimness has fallen over my eyes; I can no longer make out the land clearly!

He rose with him even higher and said to him:

- And now, what do you see?

- He replied to him: We have left the clouds behind!

Imiren, yebra-yas-d ibellireğ i wuccen: ad d-yeɣli si tis sebɛa, ad yeqber, ad yemmet.

Ar d-itenneḍ wuccen, iɣelli-d, itenneḍ-d iɣelli-d, armi tasa-s tekfa, aḍiḥan yebḍa si lxuf.

Yeffeɣ-it leɛqel: yettu Sidi ɛebdelqader, la s-yeqqar:

A Sidi ɛebdelgeṛnin!
Di temda neɣ deg walim!
A Sidi ɛebdelgeṛnin
Di temda neɣ deg walim!

Yeṭṭerḍq-d di temda: ufgen waman s igenni; yeslek si lmut, lameɛna tekka fell-as tkeffaṛt!

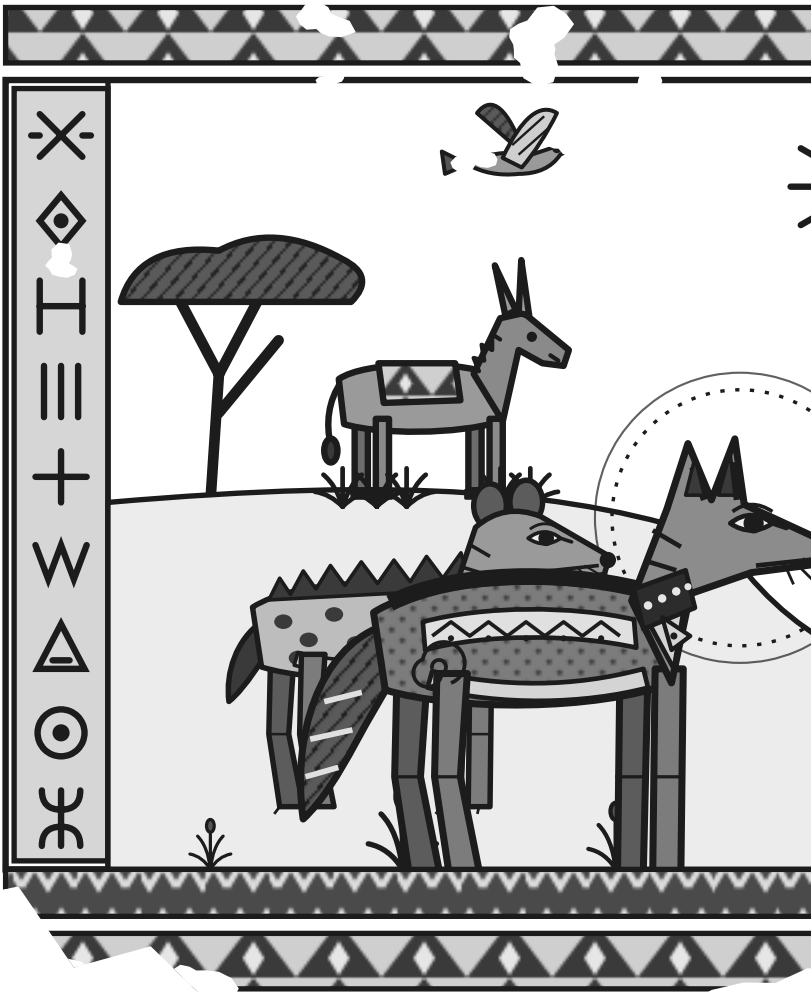
Yecɛef: seg wass nni, ur d-yecɣil d ibellireğ.

Right then, the stork let go of the wolf, so that he would fall from the seventh heaven, smash to pieces, and die.
The wolf kept twisting as he fell, twisting as he fell, until his liver was spent and his spleen burst from sheer terror.
He lost his mind completely: forgetting Saint Abdelqader, he kept crying out to him:
O Saint Abdelgernin!
In a pool or in the straw!
O Saint Abdelgernin!
In a pool or in the straw!

He burst right into a pool, and the waters splashed all the way up into the sky. He escaped death, but what a severe penance he had endured!
He had learned his lesson: from that day forward, he never troubled himself with the stork again.

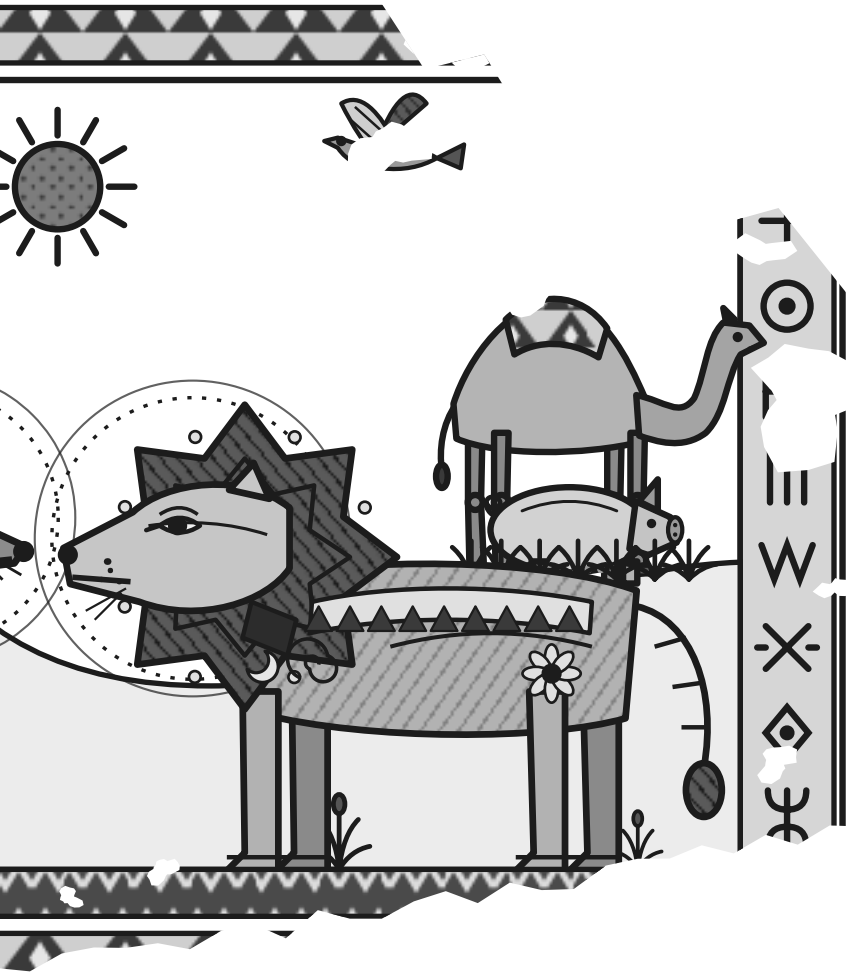
#4

Tamacahut n wuccen d yizem



#4

The Tale of the Wolf and the Lion



Leqṛaya n wuccen

Yeffeɣ-d wuccen si temda la yettergigi am yifer. Tekfa fell-as ddunit si tugdi d usemmiḍ.

Yufa aɣerbal d aqdim, yuɣal, akken iwala tileft, yeṭṭef-it d amendayer, yebda tiyita:

Ta tefla, ta ur tefli:
D ajdid i wer nufi!

Twala-t-id tileft la yettergigi, yeddekkiṛ, am win ara terkeb liḥala; tenna-yas-d:

- Teɣriḍ, a Si Mḥemmed?

- Yerra-yas: A mm uxenfuf, a mm usenfuf! Ur teẓriḍ ara nek ɣriɣ: baba yeɣra, jeddi yeɣra. A-tt-an tqubbett-is deg yiɣil inna!

Tumen-it tileft. Fran ad as-yesɣer arraw-is, iṛebbi-ten: ad as-tefk lḥeq n leɛtab-is. Tewwi-yas-ten-id ɣer lɣar-is: di tnac yid-sen, d ibelkuken: mi temmuqel deg-sen yemmatsen, ad yeğğuğğeg wul-is tečča teswa.

The Wolf's Education

The wolf came out of the pool trembling like a leaf. The world had turned upside down for him from sheer terror and cold.

He found an old sieve. Seeing the sow approaching, he held it like a frame drum and began to beat it, singing:

This hole is pierced, that one is not:
We could not find anything newer!

The sow saw him trembling and muttering as if possessed by a mystical trance. She asked him:

- Are you educated, O Sir Mḥemmed?

- He replied to her: O snout-mouth, O muzzle-snout! Do you not know that I am educated? My father was educated, and my grandfather was educated. Look, there is his domed shrine over on that hill!

The sow believed him. They agreed that he would teach her children and raise them, and she would pay him for his labor. She brought them to his cave: all twelve of them, plump little piglets. Whenever their mother looked at them, her heart bloomed with joy as if she had eaten and drunk her fill.

Yesself-asen irkel Si Mḥemmed yiwen yiwen; armi yekfa, iberra di tileft, yenna-yas:
- A lalla, iwakken ay ɣren warrac, ur d-ttṛuḥu ara ad ten-tettcewwileḍ kull ass: mi sen-d-tewwiḍ aɛwin, efk-iyi-t-id deg mi n tewwurt, tṛuḥeḍ.
- Tenna-yas: Yirbeḥ!

Tṛuḥ teğğa arraw-is, allen-is la ttbeɛṛuṛucent d imeṭṭawen.

Yebren wuccen f warraw n tileft, yečč-iten.

Yerra iɣsan-nsen di tebḍanin-nsen, iɛelleq-itent, ar ttẓenẓunen fell-asent igelfan n wareẓẓen d yizan izegzawen.

Mi d-tbedd tileft s weɛwin, yin'as wuccen:
- Sel! Sel! Akken la qqaren, sel!

Ass nni, tejjem-iten, ur tt-thenna ara tasa-s, tedhem ad ten-tẓer: tufa-n ayen tufa! Ineggez wuccen, yerwel di lɣar: tetbeɛ-it tileft, teṭṭef-it seg uḍar di ṭṭlam. Yuɣal ar idess, yeqqar-as:
- Uh! teṭṭef aẓar, tɣil d aḍar! teṭṭef aẓar, tɣil d aḍar!

Sir Mḥemmed stroked every single one of them. When he finished, he washed his hands of the sow and said to her:

- Noble lady, for the children to learn well, you must not come and disturb them every day. When you bring their provisions, leave them right at the threshold of the door and go.

- She told him: Agreed!

She left her children behind, her eyes blurring with heavy tears.

The wolf turned upon the sow's children and ate them all.

He placed their bones inside their hollow skins and hung them up. Swarms of wasps and green flies began to buzz all over them.

Whenever the sow stood outside with the provisions, the wolf would say to her:

- Listen! Listen! Hear how they are reciting! Listen!

One day, she missed them too much and her heart could not rest. She rushed inside to see them, and she found what she found! The wolf leaped away and fled deeper into the cave. The sow pursued him and caught him by the leg in the darkness. He began to laugh, saying:

- Oh! She grabbed a root and thought it was a leg! She grabbed a root and thought it was a leg!

Ikellex-as, tebra-ya, yerwel, yeffeɣ si lğiha nniḍen, yemneɛ.

He tricked her. She let go, and he fled out through the other side and escaped safely.

Izem d tileft

Arraw-is mmeččen, uccen imenɛ-as, teqqim tileft la tettru am lehwa, tezza tasa-s. Acu ara texdem? Acu ur txeddem?

Tṛuḥ ad tcetki i yizem, lmir n lewḥuc, teḥka-yas amek i s-ikellex Si Mḥemmed armi i s-tefka arraw-is ɛzizen ad ten-yesɣer, amek i t-tessɛac geddac, amek i ten-yečča, amek i s-yemneɛ. Yenna-yas yizem:
- A yelli, si zik Mḥemmed d aɣeddaṛ. Nella nṣeggem ddunit, yesxeṣr-aneɣ-tt. Ad t-texdeɛ tgella d lemleḥ i s-tesseččeḍ!
Yerẓa leɛhud n Ṛebbi, afus-is ad t-yeṭṭef! Ur ttagad: ad am-rreɣ ttaṛ.

Yuɣal yenna-yas:
- Lameɛna, nek lluẓeɣ: ad tɛemleḍ deg-i lemzegga, ad iyi-tefkeḍ aqerru-m ad t-ɣeẓẓeɣ: ad am-fkeɣ taṣwiɛt ibawen s anebdu.

The Lion and the Sow

Her children had been eaten and the wolf had escaped her; the sow remained there weeping like the rain, her heart utterly broken. What was she to do? What was she not to do?

She went to complain to the lion, the king of the animals, and she recounted to him how Sir Mḥemmed had tricked her until she gave him her beloved children to educate, how much she had provided for his livelihood, how he had eaten them, and how he had escaped her. The lion said to her:

- My daughter, since olden times Mḥemmed has been a traitor. We had set the world in order, and he ruined it for us. May the bread and the salt you fed him betray him! He has broken the covenants of God; His hand will surely seize him! Do not fear: I will take revenge for you.

Then he said to her:

- However, I am hungry: if you would do me a favor, give me your head to chew on, and I will give you a measure of broad beans in the summer.

Tileft tḥemmel ibawen: tessemḥes, walakin, seg wasmi i tt-yeɣdeṛ wuccen deg warraw-is, laman wwin-t waman.

Terra-yas:

- A lmir n lewḥuc, nek aql-i di yir ḥala: ad iyi-tanfeḍ ard qqimeɣ d yiman-iw: cubkeɣ-k s Ṛebbi ard ad d-uyaleɣ, ad ak-d-rreɣ s lexbaṛ.

Yunef-as tṛuḥ.

The sow loved broad beans: she listened to the offer, but ever since the wolf had betrayed her regarding her children, trust had been carried away by the waters. She replied to him:

- O king of the animals, I am in a terrible state: leave me be until I can compose myself. I bind you by God that I will return and bring you word.

He let her go, and she departed.

Uccen, d tileft d yizem

Uccen yeẓran tin yexdem la i yizem wala i tileft, yettagad si tili-s. Amek ara iɛass iman-is? La ten-yettɛassa nitni: mi refden aḍar, isers aḍar.

Asmi i tcetka tileft i yizem, iwala-ten, Yeqqim-as i tileft deg webrid, mi d-tuɣal, yenna-yas:
- A mm uxenfuf, a mm uzenfuf, d acu i m-d-yenna lmir n lewḥuc?
Tergem-it, tedɛa-yas; armi teɛya, teḥka-yas. Yenna-yas Si Mḥemmed:
- Ad kem-menɛeɣ si lmut, ad nemxalaṣ. A tamehbult, a tamebhult! Imi ara d as-tekfeḍ aqerru-m ad t-iɣeẓẓ, swayes ara teẓdeḍ ibawen-is s anebdu?

The Wolf, the Sow, and the Lion

The wolf, knowing what he had done to both the lion and the sow, was now afraid of his own shadow. How was he to protect himself? He kept a constant eye on them: whenever they lifted a foot, he set down his foot.

When the sow went to complain to the lion, he watched them. He waited for the sow along her path, and when she was returning, he said to her:

- O snout-mouth, O muzzle-snout, what did the king of the animals say to you?

She insulted him and cursed him; when she grew tired, she narrated to him. Sir Mḥemmed said to her:

- I will save you from death, and we shall be even. O foolish woman, O foolish woman! Once you have given him your head to chew on, with what will you grind his broad beans in the summer?

Teqqim tileft ayen teqqim, tebren s izem iwakken ur tettruẓu ara leɛhud n Ṛebbi. Tessawel-as, tenna-yas:

- A lmir n lewḥuc, ulac si ṛṛay nni i d-nger!

Yerra-yas-d awal, yenna-yas:

- A yelli, qerreb-d: tura wessreɣ: yenqes yeẓri-w, yerna aselli-w…

Tkukra, tenna-yas:

- Mi ara d ak-fkeɣ aqerru-w ad t-tɣeẓẓeḍ, swayes ara ẓdeɣ ibawen-ik s anebdu?

Iṛɛed am tegnewt, yenna-yas:

- Temmeggreḍ Mḥemmed!

- Terra-yas: Mmeggreɣ-t!

Terwel.

The sow waited for a time, then she returned to the lion so as not to break her covenant with God. She called out to him and said:

- O king of the animals, nothing will come of that matter we brought up!

He answered her, saying:

- My daughter, come closer: I have grown old now: my sight has dimmed, and my hearing as well…

She hesitated and said to him:

- If I give you my head to chew on, with what will I grind your broad beans in the summer?

He roared like a thunderstorm and said to her:

- You have crossed paths with Mḥemmed!

- She replied to him: I have crossed paths with him!

And she fled.

Izem d welɣem

Yiwwass, irwel-d yizem: tebɛen-t-id iṣeggaden.

Yemlal-d welɣem, yenna-yas:

- Dɛaɣ-k s Ṛebbi, ma ur iyi-tsellkeḍ, di leɛnaya-k!

Yerra-t welɣem ɣer teɣrart, iɛebba-t, yewwi-t.

The Lion and the Camel

One day, the lion fled: hunters were pursuing him. He crossed paths with the camel and said to him:

- I implore you by God, if you would only save me, under your protection!

The camel put him into a large sack, loaded him up, and carried him away.

Deg webrid, yemlal-d d iṣeggaden, nnan-as:

- Ay alɣem, ur temmeggerḍ ara izem iɛedda?

- Yerra-yasen: Iɛedda!

Ṛuḥen, Yewwi-t welɣem armi i t-yessaweḍ ɣer lemneɛ, isers-it. Imiren ibges-d ɣur-s yizem, yenna-yas:

- Ad k-ččeɣ!

- Yerra-yas welɣem: D lmuḥal ay d-tḍelbeḍ! Tebɛen-k-id iṣeggaden ad k-nɣen, sellkeɣ-k si lmut: tura ad iyi-teččeḍ?

Xedmeɣ-ak lxiṛ: err-iyi-t.

- Yenna-yas yizem: Ad k-ččeɣ, aɛlaxaṭer lxiṛ ur yettuɣal ara.

Yerra-yas welɣem:

- Dɛaɣ-k s Ṛebbi, ma ur iyi-tunifeḍ ad ṛuḥeɣ ad d-steqsiɣ!

Cubkeɣ-k s Ṛebbi, ma ufiɣ ur yettuɣal ara lxiṛ, ard a d-berneɣ ad iyi-teččeḍ!

Yunef-as iṛuḥ.

Along the way, he met the hunters, who asked him:

- O camel, did you not cross paths with the lion passing by?

- He replied to them: He passed!

They went on. The camel carried him until he brought him to safety, and he set him down. Right then, the lion stepped up to him and said:

- I am going to eat you!

- The camel replied to him: It is an impossible thing that you demand! Hunters were pursuing you to kill you, and I saved you from death: now you want to eat me? I did a good deed for you: return it to me.

- The lion told him: I will eat you, because a good deed is never returned.

The camel replied to him:

- I implore you by God, if you would only let me go and ask! I bind you by God, if I find that a good deed is not returned, I will come back so you can eat me!

He let him go, and he departed.

Iṛuḥ welɣem ɣer lewḥuc. A win yemmegger, yeḥku-yas: yiwen i Ṛebbi ur as-yefki lḥeq. Yenna-yas weɣyul:
- Ur k-yeḍlim ara yizem: nek d akli n wexxam: ad ɛebbiɣ, srekbeɣ; ad ččeɣ yir tmecḥa, ad rnuɣ aɛekkaz; yuɣal yisem-iw d taselqubt: lxiṛ ur yettuɣal ara.
- Tenna-yas tixsi: Ur k-yeḍlim ara yizem: ad fkeɣ ayefki d taduṭ, ad d-arweɣ izamaren, ad ten-zlun, zlun-iyi; ččen-ten, ččen-iyi: lxiṛ ur yettuɣal ara.
- Yenna-yas wezger: D keč ay d ḍḍalem: Ad kerzeɣ irden d temẓin, ad meggleɣ izemran d wurtan: acu n lxiṛ ara d iyi-rren? Ad iyi-qeddmen s aɛric! Lukan yettuɣal lxiṛ, talli yuɣal i wezger.

Yebren welɣem deg uɣilif meqqer: mačči akken yebna i-yufa: imi lxiṛ yettmečča, ad as-t-yečč kan yizem, yečč-it zdeffir-s.
La ileḥḥu welɣem yettru: mačči akken yeṭṭes i d-yuki!

The camel went to the animals. Whomever he crossed paths with, he narrated to him; not a single one, for God's sake, gave him justice. The donkey said to him:

- The lion has not wronged you: I am the slave of the house. I carry loads, I carry riders; I eat bad food, and I receive the stick besides. Then my name becomes an insult: a good deed is never returned.

- The ewe said to him: The lion has not wronged you: I give milk and wool, I bring forth lambs, they slaughter them, and they slaughter me; they eat them, and they eat me: a good deed is never returned.

- The ox said to him: It is you who are the wrongdoer: I plow the wheat and the barley, I cultivate the olive trees and the orchards: what good deed do they return to me? They lead me straight to the butchery slab! If a good deed were ever returned, it would have been returned to the ox.

The camel turned in deep sorrow; it was not as he had imagined. For since a good deed is eaten, the lion will eat it, and will eat him next.
The camel walked along weeping: it was not as he had slept that he awoke!

Yemlal-d d wuccen deg webrid, yenna-yas-d:
- D acu k-yuɣen, a ɛemmi Bumgerḍ?
Yeḥka-yas welɣem tamsalt. Yenna-yas wuccen:
- D ṣṣeḥ: lxiṛ ur yettuɣal ara: tura ad k-yečč, ay amcum.

Yuɣal welɣem ar yettreɛreɛ. Yenna-yas wuccen:
-Tettalaseḍ-iyi-tt: ad k-sellkeɣ, ma isellek-ik Ṛebbi, ad nemxalaṣ. Imiren, yemla-yas deg umeẓẓuɣ.

Iṛuḥ welɣem armi yewweḍ s izem, yenna-yas:
- A lmir n lewḥyc, d ṣṣeḥ: lxiṛ ur yettuɣal ara.
Yebda yizem ar yettmiẓẓid, yenna-yas:
- Ihi, ad k-ččeɣ!
- Yenna-yas welɣem: S leɛqel, a lmir n lewḥuc!
Ssiweḍ-iyi deg wawal: lxiṛ ur yettuɣal ara ɣer yir laṣel: ɣer tarrawt n laṣel, lxiṛ yettuɣal.

He crossed paths with the wolf along the way, who said to him:

- What is the matter with you, Uncle Long-Neck?

The camel narrated the matter to him. The wolf said to him:

- It is the truth: a good deed is never returned. Now he will eat you, you wretched one.

Then the camel began to groan. The wolf said to him:

- You have a claim on me: I will save you, if God saves you, and we shall be even. Right then, he whispered into his ear.

The camel walked on until he reached the lion, and he said to him:

- O king of the animals, it is the truth: a good deed is never returned.

The lion began to stretch himself and said to him:

- Therefore, I will eat you!

The camel said to him: Gently, O king of the animals! Let me finish my words: a good deed is never returned to a wicked origin; to the children of noble origin, a good deed is always returned.

Yedduqqes yizem. iṛɛed am tegnewt: ur yezmir ara ad yessemsu laṣel-is. Yenna-yas i welɣem:

- Temmeggreḍ uccen!

- Yerra-yas: Mmugreɣ-t, a lmir n lewḥuc.

- Yenna-yas yizem: ṛuḥ: isellek-ik bu meyya tḥila! Iṛuḥ welɣem di laman u ḍman.

The lion startled. He roared like a thunderstorm: he could not allow his own origin to be defiled. He said to the camel:

- You have crossed paths with the wolf!

- He replied to him: I have crossed paths with him, O king of the animals.

- The lion said to him: Go; the one of a hundred ruses has saved you!

The camel departed in safety and security.

Tlata yezgaren, d wuccen d yizem

Llan tlata yezgaren, yiwen d amellal, wayeḍ d aberkan, wis tlata d azeggaɣ, weqmen tagmatt di teẓgi. Mi ksan jmiɛ ar tameddit, ad ssemlilen tiseḍwa-nsen, ad mekknen acciwen-nsen ɣer beṛṛa, ad ṭṭsen. Mi d-yusa yizem, ad-yaf mkul yiwen seg-sen iqurɛ-d lğiha-s: ad asen-d-yenneḍ, ad iṛuḥ: ur assen-yezmir ara.

Yiwwass, iṛuḥ wuccen s azger abrkan, yenna-yas:
- Sliɣ i watmaten-ik la ttsewwiqen deg-k, ad k-sebblen i yizem ad k-yečč, ad asen-d-teqqim lɣaba weḥd-sen.

Iɛawed-as akenni i wezger azeggaɣ, yerna-yas akkenni i wezger amellal: yeḍmeɛ ad ten-yessemneɣ, ad yečč seg-sen.

Yessekcem-asen ccekk: yuɣal yekfa laman gar-asen: la ttemyexẓaren, ttemyenfasen. Mi d-yewweḍ yiḍ, di lɛuḍ ara ssemlilen tiseḍwa-nsen am zik, mekknen acciwen-nsen ɣer beṛṛa, uɣalen la ssemlilin acciwen-nsen, ttemɛassan n way gar-asen.

The Three Oxen, the Wolf, and the Lion

There were three oxen: one was white, another black, and the third red; they formed a brotherhood in the forest. When they grazed together until evening, they would join their backsides together, project their horns outward, and sleep. When the lion arrived, he would find that every single one of them was guarding his own side; he would circle around them and leave, for he was not strong enough to face them.

One day, the wolf went to the black ox and said to him:

- I heard your brothers plotting against you; they are going to sacrifice you to the lion so he will eat you, and then the forest will belong to them alone.

He repeated the same thing to the red ox, and did the same again to the white ox, hoping to set them against one another so that he could eat from their remains.

He planted doubt among them, and from then on trust was finished between them: they glared at one another with hostility and mutual suspicion. When night fell, instead of joining their backsides as they used to do, projecting their horns outward, they turned to join their horns inward, watching each other for any sudden betrayal.

Yiwwass, yewt-d yizem azger aberkan, yerẓa-t di tqeṣrit, yewwi-t, yečča-t. Ass nniḍen, yewt-d azger azeggaɣ, yerẓa-t di tqeṣrit, yewwi-t, yečča-t. Yeqqim-d wezger amellal weḥd-s, am gujil: ewt-it, i Ṛebbi: eğğ-it, i Ṛebbi!

Yeqqim-d wezger amellal la yettru f watmaten-is, yettergigi f yiman-is. Iṛuḥ s uccen ad t-id-iciweṛ. Yenna-yas:

- Dɛaɣ-k s Ṛebbi: ḍebber fell-i akken tḍebbreḍ f welɣem d tileft, ma ulac ad iyi-yečč yizem!

Ihuz aqerru-s wuccen, yerra-yas-d:

- Ddeɛwa-k tewɛeṛ!

Yeɛreḍ bu meyya tḥila a s-yessefhem tamsalt: azger, nneyya-s d tazurant: ur as-yufi ara amek ara t-yesɣer. Yuɣal iɛeggen-as:

- Asmi temmeggreḍ lmir n lewḥuc, siwel-as tidett.

One day, the lion struck the black ox, broke his spine, carried him away, and ate him. Another day, he struck the red ox, broke his spine, carried him away, and ate him. The white ox was left all alone, like an orphan: strike him, for God's sake—leave him, for God's sake!

The white ox remained there weeping for his brothers and trembling for his own skin. He went to the wolf to seek his counsel. He said to him:

- I implore you by God: advise me just as you advised the camel and the sow, otherwise the lion will eat me!

The wolf shook his head and answered him:

- Your case is a difficult one!

The master of a hundred ruses tried to explain the matter to him, but the ox's innocence was too thick: the wolf found no way to instruct him. Finally, he gave him this warning:

- When you cross paths with the king of the animals, speak the truth to him.

Yiwwass deg wussan ger unebdu d tefsut, ddunit tezzegzew teğğuğğeg, ṭikkuk, la yekkat yewt-d nnaɛuṛ azger amellal: yejfel, taseṭṭa-s deg genni, la yesruhmut, ireggel: talat tettak-it i talat, iɣẓer i yeɣẓer, tiɣilt i tiɣilt, armi yeɣli f yizem ur yebni fell-as.

Yenna-yas:

- D acu k-id-yewwin ɣer dagi, a mmis n tfunast? Kra ddaw uqerru-k! Lameɛna, ɛuhdeɣ-k s Ṛebbi ur k-ččiɣ ma tsawleḍ-iyi tidett.

Iɣil ad d-yeskiddeb, ad t-yečč. Yerra-yas uɛerrum:

- Uḥeq wadi… d wadi… a lmir n lewḥuc, a lukan ẓriɣ ad k-id-afeɣ dagi, ur d-rwileɣ, ɣas ad yečč nnaɛuṛ tasa-w!

Yenna-yi Si Mḥemmed: siwel-as tidett!

Iṛɛed yizem am tegnewt, yenna-yas:

-Ṛuḥ! Tselkeḍ a bu nneyya.

Ma ur tessineḍ ara ad teskiddbeḍ, siwel tidett: nneyya tesserbaḥ neɣ tessukkus.

One day during the seasons between summer and spring, when the world was green and blooming and the coucou bird was calling, the horsefly struck the white ox. He bolted in a panic, his tail raised high into the air, bellowing and running blindly: valley gave him up to valley, ravine to ravine, ridge to ridge, until he crashed right on top of the lion without having expected him.

The lion said to him:

- What has brought you here, O son of the cow? Something bad is brewing under your head! However, I covenant with you by God that I will not eat you if you tell me the truth.

The lion thought he would catch him in a lie and eat him. The honest simpleton replied to him:

- By the truth of this... and this... O king of the animals, if I had known I would find you here, I would never have fled my home, even if the horsefly had eaten my very liver! Sir Mḥemmed told me: speak the truth to him!

The lion roared like a thunderstorm and said to him:

- Go! Your innocence has saved you, O master of simplicity.

If you do not know how to lie, speak the truth: innocence brings good fortune or delivers one from ruin.

Izem d wuccen d yifis

Asmi yufa yizem anga tent-iger qqurent seg wuccen, ayen ara d-yeğğ ad t-id-yaf yečča-t netta d yifis la t-ttabaɛen, yemṣalaḥ yid-sen i sin, iɛahed-iten s Ṛebbi ur ten-yečči. Yenna-yas yizem i wuccen:

Yya, a ddib, ad nṣafeṛ,
D rrbeḥ-ik iban ɟell-i:
Ma nɣiɣ si medden, ad teččeḍ;
Ma nɣan-i medden, teččeḍ-i!

Cerken taxerraẓt seg wass nni: nitni ttqeddimen-as-d ṣṣyada; netta yettɣimi-yas deg wemḍiq, yettruẓu-tt. Mi yekfa lmakla, ččen nitni tisigar. Lḥan akkenni ayen lḥan.

The Lion, the Wolf, and the Hyena

Once the lion realized that all his attempts against the wolf had failed, and whatever prey he left behind would be eaten by the wolf and the hyena —who both always followed him—, he then made peace with them. He covenanted with them by God that he would never eat them. The lion said to the wolf:

Come, O wolf, let us travel together,
Your good fortune is guaranteed with me:
If I kill anyone, you shall eat;
If anyone kills me, you shall eat me!

They joined together in banditry from that day forward: the two of them would flush out the prey, while he would wait for it in his place and crush it down. When he finished eating, they would eat the scraps. They went on like this for some time.

Yiwwass, nɣan-d axeṛfi d tixsi d izimer. Iḍleb-d yifis beṭṭu. Yenna-yas yizem:

- Ferq-iten gar-aneɣ.

Iferq-iten yifis: axeṛfi i yizem, tixsi i yiman-is, izimer i wuccen. Yewt-it yizem, ntan waccaren-is di tasa-s, yedda-d leɛmeṛ-is. Yenna-yas i wuccen:

- Ferq-iten kečči̇ni.

- Yenna-yas wuccen: A lmir n lewḥuc, izimer, ad tsefsuḍ yess imi-k; axeṛfi, ad tfetreḍ yess; tixsi, ad tt-teččeḍ d imensi.

-Yenna-yas yizem: Wi k-yefkan tamusni yagi, a Mḥemmed?

-Iğaweb-it-id: D accaren-ik yentan di tasa n yifis!

One day, they killed a ram, a ewe, and a lamb. The hyena demanded a division of the spoils. The lion said to him:

- Divide them among us.

The hyena divided them: the ram for the lion, the ewe for himself, and the lamb for the wolf. The lion struck him, his claws sinking deep into his liver, and his life went with it. Then he said to the wolf:

- You do the dividing yourself.

- The wolf said to him: O king of the animals, as for the lamb, you shall open your mouth with it; as for the ram, you shall lunch on it; and as for the ewe, you shall eat her for your dinner.

- The lion said to him: Who gave you such wisdom as this, O Mḥemmed?

- He answered him: Your claws sinking into the liver of the hyena!

Izem d wuccen d userdun

Yelḥa yizem d wuccen ayen lḥan, mlalen-d d userdun. Ɛuhden-t s Ṛebbi ur t-ččin, uɣalen dduklen.

Aserdun yeṛwa leḥcic: idewweṛ, yellemlem, ad t-tedhen tiqit n zzit.

Mi mmuqlen deg-s imeddukal-is, ar d-yettarew yimi-nsen aman.

The Lion, the Wolf, and the Mule

The lion and the wolf walked on for some time, and they crossed paths with the mule.
They covenanted with him by God that they would not eat him, and from then on they traveled together.

The mule ate his fill of grass: he grew round and shone, as though a drop of oil had anointed him.

Whenever his companions looked at him, their mouths would water.

Uɣalen mcawaṛen fell-as ad t-ččen, rẓen leɛhud n Ṛebbi.
Yenna-yas wuccen:
- Nekni aql-aɣ nemmut si laẓ: yessefk yiwen seg-neɣ ad isebbel iman-is iwakken ad selken wiyaḍ! Tura, a win yellan d yir laṣel deg-neɣ, ad t-nečč.
Yenna-yas yizem:
- Nek, baba d izem, yemma d tasedda!
Inṭeq-d wuccen, yenna:
- Ulac laṣel yifen axxam n lmir n lewḥuc!
Yenna-yas wuccen:
- Nek, baba d uccen, yemma d tuccent.
Inṭeq-d yizem, yenna:
- D laṣel!
Yeqqim-d userdun: yenna-yasen:
- Nek, yemma d tagmart, xali d aɛudiw; ɣas ar baba, ur t-ssineɣ ara. (Yugad ad d-yini d aɣyul.)
Nnan-as:
- Mačči akka! Ini-yaneɣ wi d babak neɣ ad k-nečč!
- Yerra-yasen-d: Serrḥet-iyi ad ṛuḥeɣ ad d-steqsiɣ fell-as.
Cubkeɣ-kwen s Ṛebbi ard a d-uɣaleɣ, ad awen-d-awiɣ lexbaṛ n ṣṣeḥ.
Serrḥen-as iṛuḥ.

Eventually, they plotted against him to eat him, breaking the covenants of God. The wolf said to him:

- We are dying of hunger: one of us must sacrifice himself so that the others can survive! Therefore, whoever among us has a wicked origin, we shall eat him.

The lion said:

- As for me, my father is a lion, and my mother is a lioness!

The wolf spoke up and said:

- There is no lineage finer than the house of the king of the animals!

Then the wolf said:

- As for me, my father is a wolf, and my mother is a she-wolf.

The lion spoke up and said:

- What a lineage!

That left only the mule, who said to them:

- As for me, my mother is a mare, and my maternal uncle is a stallion; but as for my father, I never knew him. (He was afraid to say it was a donkey.)

They said to him:

- Not so! Tell us who your father is, or else we will eat you!

- He replied to them: Allow me to go and ask about him. I bind you by God that I will return and bring you the true word.

They let him go, and he departed.

Lmut n yizem

Yuɣal wuccen yeṭṭef aserdun weḥd-s, sewwqen deg uqerru n yizem, ad iṛuḥ am tadla yečča yilef.

Yewweḍ userdun s aḥeddad: igerrez-as-d tasmiṛt, inqec-itt-id, yesɣezf-as-d imesmaṛen, Ssyen, ibren-d s imddukal-is. Yenna-yas yizem:

- Ihi, anwa i d baba-k?

- Yerra-yas userdun: Ur ufiɣ ara lexbaṛ-is, lameɛna yeğğa-yi-d ttajiṛa deg ḍarren-iw: ma tebɣam ad tt-id-teɣrem.

Yenna-yas yizem i wuccen:

- Qerreb eɣr-itt-id, a Mḥemmed.

- Yerra-yas wuccen: A lmir n lewḥuc, nek, imawlan-iw d igellilen: ur iyi-fkin ɣer leqraya. D keč ay d mmis n wexxam ameqran: tessenḍ ad tt-id-teɣreḍ.

Iqerreb yizem axencuc-is, yesteɛmel ad iɣer: leɛmaṛa terɣa: ibedd userdun f imezwura, yewt-it-id s ineggura: kecmen imesmaṛen di lmux n yizem, yeɣli.

The Death of the Lion

In the meantime, the wolf took the mule aside, and they plotted against the head of the lion, so that he would go down like a bundle of straw eaten by a boar.

The mule went to a blacksmith, who fitted him with fine shoes, engraved them, and left the nails protruding long. Then, he turned back to his companions. The lion said to him:

- Well then, who is your father?

- The mule replied to him: "I could not find any word of him, but he left me an inscription under my hooves; if you wish, you may read it.
The lion said to the wolf:

- Come closer and read it, O Mḥemmed.

- The wolf replied to him: O king of the animals, as for me, my parents were poor folk: they never sent me to school. It is you who are the child of a great house; you know how to read it.

The lion brought his snout close, feigning an ability to read: the charge was primed. The mule planted himself on his front legs and struck out with his hind ones; the nails entered straight into the brain of the lion, and he fell.

Werɛad yessufeɣ taṛwiḥt, yeɛna-t wuccen s acekkab.
Yenna-yas yizem:
- Ah! ddunit d wi ibedden, ɣas ad yili baba-s d aɣyul!

Yemmut yizem, bu tissas, lmir n lewḥuc: yenɣa-t
userdun, mmi-s n weɣyul, ččan-t wuccanen.
Seg wass nni ay txab tmurt.

Before he had even given up his soul, the wolf was already at his hock, biting him.
The lion said to him:

- Ah! The world belongs to whoever stands strong, even if his father is a donkey!

Thus died the lion, the master of courage, the king of the animals: he was killed by the mule, the son of a donkey, and the wolves ate him.
It is from that very day that the land fell into ruin.





I warrac

Tamacahut-iw lwad lwad:
Sawleɣ-tt-id i tarrawt n leğwad.
Nekni nṛuḥ abrid abrid,
Uccen iṛuḥ lexla lexla:
Yewt-aɣ-d s tesfenğett: nečča-tt;
Newt-it s weẓru, nerẓa-t!
Nekni, ad aɣ-yeṛḥem Ṛebbi;
Uccanen, ad ten-yeḥreq Ṛebbi!

Tasekkurt tezreɛ tineqqict,
Tefka-d ijeğğigen:
Teglalez deg-s,
Telsa-d am teslit.
Temmuqel s igenni,
Tkeḥḥel-d ṭiṭṭuct-is
Tezger tiɣẓert,
Teqqen-d lḥenni.
Tṣubb takessart,
Terkeb f tserdunt-is.

To the Children

My story goes along the river, along the river:
I have recited it for the children of noble souls.
We went along the path, along the path,
While the wolf took to the wild, to the wild:
He threw a fritter to us, and we ate it;
We threw a stone at him, and we broke him!
As for us, may God have mercy on us;
As for the wolves, may God burn them!

The partridge sowed a small plot,
And it brought forth flowers:
She rolled and tumbled in it,
And she was dressed like a bride.
She looked up toward the sky,
And it painted her sweet eye with kohl.
She crossed the mountain stream,
And it bound her feet with henna.
She went down the slope,
Riding upon her mule.

Uccen yezreɛ tineqqict,
Tefka-d isennanen:
Yeglalez deg-s,
Tedda-d tebḍant-is.
Yemmuqel s igenni,
Tedderɣel tṭiṭṭuct-is.
Yezger tiɣẓert,
Tedda-d tmessaṭ-is.
Yuli-d tasawent,
Terḍ-d tẓemmumt-is.

The wolf sowed a small plot,
And it brought forth thorns:
He rolled and tumbled in it,
And his skin was torn away.
He looked up toward the sky,
And his sweet eye was blinded.
He crossed the mountain stream,
And his thigh was carried away.
He went up the steep slope,
And his snout burst open.

Lxattima

A widen irkel i yi-d-yeslan,
Ur nelli d imunan,
Ad tmeyyzem taḥkayt agi.
D kenwi yakk ay d-lhaɣ,
Iwakken ad ken-menɛeɣ,
Si tyitwin n Ṛebbi.

A win yellan di lḥekma
Yexdem lewqama,
Bac ad yerkeb, ur yettrus.
Ad yefk leqdeṛ i umeqran,
Iḥader ameẓyan,
Fell-as ur ttaken afus.

Izem, yella deg wawal,
Izemren i ccwal,
Ssemrarɣen-t deg wemṛaḥ.
Xelli ɛad a bunadem,
Yellan d lɛadem,
Ha kan akka ad yenjaḥ.

The Conclusion

To all those who have listened to me,
You who are not unmindful or simple-minded,
Reflect deeply upon this tale.
It is for all of you that I have labored,
In order to spare you
God's blows.

Whosoever stands in a position of authority
Let him act with complete uprightness,
So that he may remain mounted, and never be brought low.
Let him give due honor to the great,
And shelter the small,
So that no hand shall ever be lifted against him.

Even the lion, as is well known,
Who was strong enough for any strife,
Was stretched out dead upon the ground.
How much more so for the child of Adam,
Who is made of mere frailty,
In one suspended instant, he plummets into misery.

Ma d w'illan d menwala,
Iḍuɛen i ddewla,
Ur yettili d alemmam.
Ma la yettɛanad uccen,
Yesnaɣa medden,
Kulwa yesɣab-as nadam.

Lemqassa dɣa tegguni-t,
Lḥirfa-s tesdull-it,
Ttgammin medden ad t-walin,
Yiwwass ur nelhi fell-as,
Ad t-iwwet uɛessas,
Ad ɣunfun w'ad t-ilawin.

Times ad tekker deg wul-is,
Amzun day d Yeblis,
Ur yelli w'ad tt-yessexsin.
Ad d-yaf iman-is di lkaf,
Yemmet s nncaf:
D lxeṭṭ n Lleh lḥanin.

D Si Rabeḥ, ad fell-as nendem
Imi d lfahem:
Tikli ines tezga teṣfa.
Yessakay widen iɣeflen,
Ttafen-t yeḥbiben,
Ssuq yid-s ḥaca lfayda.

As for the one who is an ordinary man,
Who obeys the authority of the land,
Let him never become a deceitful plotters.
If he goes about imitating the wolf,
Setting people against one another,
He will steal the sleep from everyone's eyes.

The ultimate retribution is waiting for him,
His treacherous trade will bring him low,
And people will refuse to even look upon him.
One day, an evil day will fall upon him,
The Guardian will strike him down,
And both men and women will turn from him in disgust.

A burning fire will kindle within his heart,
As if he were the Devil himself,
And there will be no one to extinguish it.
He will find himself trapped in a deep chasm,
Dying a parched, agonizing death:
By the strict decree of God the Merciful.

It is for Sir Rabeḥ that we shall grieve,
For he was a man of deep understanding:
His path was ever pure and unblemished.
He awakened those who were heedless,
His friends always found him true,
And dealing with him brought nothing but blessing.

Akka ay d bunadem yelhan,
Iḍefren iberdan
Ɣef d-tweṣṣa ccaṛiɛa.
Ɣas fell-as tewɛeṛ, ddunit,
Lameɛna, am targit,
Lxattima ines d ṛṛeḥma.

Such is the upright child of Adam,
Who follows the true paths
Decreed by the sacred law.
Though the world may be harsh and unyielding to him,
It passes away just like a dream,
And his ultimate end is mercy.